Lean on Vampire *Models*

Kernel-Checked Finite Counter-Models for Lean 4: a Verified Reflective Checker, a Measured Scaling Recipe, and a Million-Fact Certificate

Michael Jagdeo, Exponent Labs LLC Jeff Dumps

Whitepaper, October 2026. Code and data: https://github.com/exponentlabshq/lean-countermodel

Contents

Abstract . . . 1
List of tables and figures . . . 2
1. Introduction . . . 2
2. Background and Problem . . . 4
3. Method: Find, Rewrite, Compile, Certify . . . 5
4. The Verified Checker: Data Structures and Trust . . . 11
5. Scaling: Design Patterns, Data Structures and Measured Effects . . . 17
6. Evaluation and Case Studies . . . 23
7. Related Work . . . 28
8. Limitations and Future Work . . . 32
9. Conclusion . . . 34
Appendix A: Reproducing Every Number . . . 34
References . . . 35

Abstract

To show that axioms do **not** imply a claim, one exhibits a structure in which the axioms hold and the claim fails. Isabelle has had a finder for such counter-models for over fifteen years. Lean 4 can import *proofs* from automated provers and search for concrete counterexamples in fixed types, but it has no general, automated way to obtain counter-models of abstract first-order theories; projects build them by hand.

We present `lean-countermodel`, which turns finite models found by the Vampire prover into certificates checked by Lean's kernel. Certificates take two forms:

- **Shallow:** the model as a Lean inductive type, with one theorem per formula.
- **Reflected:** a Lean library defines first-order formulas as data, a Boolean evaluator, and ordinary first-order structures. It proves, once, that for a model whose domain is non-empty and whose functions are closed, and for closed, well-formed formulas, the evaluator agrees with **ordinary first-order satisfaction** in a structure on `Fin n`. A certificate checks validity, well-formedness and truth in one kernel evaluation, and concludes that this structure satisfies every formula. It uses only Lean's standard axioms (`propext`, `Quot.sound`).

Vampire is untrusted: a model that is ill-formed or that falsifies the encoded problem yields no certificate. The translation from TPTP into Lean remains trusted code, tested against an independent evaluator of the *original* formulas.

Most of the work is in making the check finish. One benchmark clause has about 10^{11} cases, and a 10,000-formula file overflowed Lean 4.13's kernel. We give a recipe of classic patterns: backtracking via miniscoping, bitsets, balanced trees, hierarchical aggregation, content-addressed caching, blocking and reflection. Each is kept or rejected on measurement, and we report the negative results. For our large ground-fact certificates, the cost was dominated by elaborating statements rather than evaluating them. Quantifier-heavy checking has a separate evaluation bottleneck.

Evaluation:

- **A development set** of 100 TPTP problems with status Satisfiable or CounterSatisfiable [34] (fof/cnf), rerun with the final frozen code: Vampire returned 77 finite models. **70 were certified under our strict kernel-only policy (90.9% of models, 70% of problems).** Two more were certified with native evaluation, which enlarges the trusted base. None of the 5 failures is an invalid certificate.
- **A held-out set** of 100 further problems, drawn uniformly with a fixed seed and checked with the frozen implementation: Vampire found 61 finite models, and **54 were certified strictly (88.5% of models, 54% of problems)**, 2 more with native evaluation; 4 inputs use unsupported syntax and are rejected, not misread. Certification generalizes; the finder's 30 s yield is what falls (61 against 77 models).
- **A million-fact theory.** NLP263+1 (1,026,857 facts) is certified in a median 5.2 minutes reflected, against 14.1 minutes shallow, in a controlled, repeated comparison on the same Lean version, worker budget and laptop: about 2.7× in wall time and 2.6× in CPU time. Its model has one element, so this measures certificate throughput, not combinatorial checking.
- **A published Lean formalization.** The tool reproduces, from axioms alone, both hand-built counter-models of Nakamura's Lean reconstruction of Spinoza's *Ethics*, with smaller models. It also produces a certified negative-dependency map of that reconstruction's register.

Keywords: Lean 4 · finite model finding · counter-models · Vampire · TPTP · proof by reflection · certificates · interactive theorem proving

---

List of tables and figures

- Figure: 3.1 Pipeline
- Table: 3.3 Model parse: `model(path)`
- Table: 3.4 Rewrite: `problem`, `literals`, `clause`, `miniscope`
- Figure: 3.4 Rewrite: `problem`, `literals`, `clause`, `miniscope`
- Table: 3.5 Compile (shallow): `emit`
- Table: 3.8 Trust boundary
- Figure: 3.9 Worked example: `transitive_cnf`
- Table: 3.9 Worked example: `transitive_cnf`
- Table: 3.10 Independent checks (`test_cm.py`)
- Table: 4.1 Data structures
- Table: 4.2 Models in generated certificates
- Table: 4.3 Problem encodings
- Figure: 4.3 Problem encodings
- Table: 4.4 Soundness
- Table: 4.5 Shallow vs reflected certificates
- Table: 4.6 Independent checks of the reflected path (`test_cm.py`)
- Table: 5. Scaling: Design Patterns, Data Structures and Measured Effects
- Table: 5.1 Master table
- Table: 5.3 NLP263+1: shallow vs reflected
- Figure: 5.4 Illustrations
- Table: 6.1 Case study A: a published Lean formalization (Spinoza's *Ethics*)
- Table: 6.1.1 The assumption-dependency map
- Table: 6.2 Case study B: a uniform sample of TPTP
- Table: 6.2.1 Held-out evaluation with a frozen implementation
- Table: 6.3.1 Controlled comparison
- Table: 6.4 Summary
- Table: 7.6 Comparison
- Table: 8.1 Supported input
- Table: 8.2 Limitations
- Table: Appendix A: Reproducing Every Number

1. Introduction

Formal developments are full of *negative* claims:

- this axiom is independent of those;
- this hypothesis is needed;
- this conjecture is false;
- these assumptions are consistent.

Each is shown the same way. One exhibits a **counter-model**: a structure that satisfies the premises and falsifies the conclusion. Automated model finders such as Mace4 and Vampire's finite-model builder find small counter-models in milliseconds. Isabelle users have had Nitpick for this since 2010 [3].

Lean 4 users have no equivalent for abstract theories. Lean can replay proofs from automated provers, and it can search for concrete counterexamples over types it already knows, such as `Nat` and `Fin n`. Lean can *represent* any finite structure, but it has no general automated front end that *finds* one, a universe together with interpretations of uninterpreted symbols, and certifies it. So Lean projects build their counter-models by hand. For example, the two non-derivability results in a recent Lean formalization of Spinoza's *Ethics* rest on hand-built models of 4 and 3 elements [22, §4.4]. The Equational Theories Project [1] built project-specific machinery to check about 587,000 magma counterexamples.

1.1 Motivation: philosophy written in geometric order

Spinoza's *Ethics* was published in 1677 as *Ethica ordine geometrico demonstrata*, "demonstrated in geometrical order". Like Euclid, it gives definitions, axioms and propositions, each with a demonstration citing earlier ones. A philosophy written this way invites machine checking. Its central arguments have been disputed for three and a half centuries; whether Proposition 5 ("no two substances share an attribute") follows from what Spinoza states is one example.

Formal philosophy has long used automated provers and model finders on such questions [28]. Examples include computational metaphysics with Prover9 and Mace [29], a computationally discovered simplification of the ontological argument [30], a computer-assisted reconstruction of an ontological argument in the *Ethics* itself [31], and recent Lean 4 work on Gödel's and Scott's ontological arguments [21]. A research agenda for this field describes a seven-stage workflow, with the companion paper `paper/formal-philosophy.md` as the starting point: reconstruct the text, axiomatize it, explore with an automated prover, check candidate models independently, verify in a proof assistant, *ablate* each assumption, and review the interpretation. It frames the field's most important output as **a map of the assumptions that hold a theory together**, and we know of no tool that produces such a map with certified counter-models.

`lean-countermodel` implements stages 3–6 for first-order reconstructions. Applied to a published Lean formalization of the *Ethics* [22], it produces that map (§6.1.1), with every "this assumption is needed" backed by a counter-model that Lean's kernel checks.

1.2 Contributions

This paper. We connect Vampire's finite-model builder to Lean's kernel, for untyped first-order problems in TPTP (`fof` and `cnf`; §8 lists the unsupported features), and we make the result scale. The contributions are:

1. **A tool, `lean-countermodel`,** which compiles a Vampire model into a Lean certificate. Vampire is untrusted: a model that is ill-formed or falsifies the encoded problem yields no certificate (§3).
2. **A verified reflective checker** (`Checker.lean`). It provides first-order formulas as data, a Boolean evaluator, and ordinary first-order structures, and proves once that, for a valid model (non-empty domain, closed functions) and closed, well-formed formulas, the evaluator agrees with ordinary satisfaction on `Fin n` (`sem_iff_sat`). Certificates conclude that this structure satisfies every formula, with Lean's standard axioms only (§4).
3. **A measured scaling recipe.** Classic algorithmic patterns, each kept or rejected on measurement, take certificates from about 10^{11} cases, and from files that crash Lean's kernel, to a million-fact problem certified in under five minutes. Three findings generalize to anyone generating large Lean certificates:
   - Lean's cost is **elaborating statements, not evaluating them**;
   - **one Lean 4.13 file cannot hold more than about 20,600 declarations**;
   - **lazy kernel evaluation punishes nested data** (§5).
4. **An evaluation.** It covers a uniform 100-problem sample of TPTP's finite-model problems, a 1,026,857-fact problem, and a published Lean formalization (§6).
5. **An assumption-dependency map** of Nakamura's register for *Ethics* I (§6.1.1), produced by a reusable ablation tool (`ablate.py`).
6. **A trust case study.** Four real bugs in the trusted rewrite and naming layers, one of which made Lean certify a statement other than the intended one, were each caught by an independent check. Peer review then led us to

two more: silent misreading of unsupported TPTP syntax, now closed by fail-closed parsing, and a TPTP variable named `T` capturing the domain type (Lean rejected it; variables are now primed), and to a kernel-checked validity theorem for the checker's semantics (§4, §5, §8).

What is not new. Model finding, kernel-checked finite certificates and proof by reflection are each well established (§7). The closest predecessor is Goubault-Larrecq's extraction of finite models of first-order clause sets with Coq-checkable model-checking proofs [32]; finite model theory itself has been mechanized in Coq [33]. Our contribution is a specific, implemented combination: general untyped first-order models from Vampire, certified in Lean 4 by a verified reflective evaluator with a validity theorem, at the scale measured here. A focused search found no implementation with this combination; that is not a claim of first-ever status.

2. Background and Problem

2.1 Counter-models

A first-order *problem* is a set of axioms Γ and, optionally, a conjecture φ. A **counter-model** is a structure $\mathcal{M}$ with $\mathcal{M} \models \Gamma$ and $\mathcal{M} \not\models \varphi$. By soundness of first-order logic, a counter-model proves $\Gamma \not\vdash \varphi$. If there is no conjecture, a model of Γ shows that Γ is consistent. A **finite** counter-model has a finite universe $\{0, \ldots, n-1\}$ and finite tables for every constant, function and predicate. Checking it is decidable by enumeration, but naive enumeration costs n^v cases for a formula with v variables.

2.2 TPTP and Vampire

TPTP [23] is the standard problem library for automated theorem proving. Its 26,990 problems each carry a status. **2,561 of them are untyped first-order (`fof` or `cnf`) with status *Satisfiable* or *CounterSatisfiable*.** These statuses mean a model exists, not that a *finite* one does: the SZS ontology has separate *FinitelySatisfiable* and *FinitelyCounterSatisfiable* statuses [34]. A theory may have only infinite models, so a finite-model finder can fail on these problems for reasons other than time. Vampire [24] includes a finite-model builder (`-sa fmb`), which prints models as TPTP `tff` tables. We use it as an untrusted oracle.

2.3 Lean 4's kernel and `decide`

Lean 4 [25] is an interactive theorem prover whose small kernel checks proof terms. For a decidable proposition P:

- **`decide`** evaluates the `Decidable P` instance in the elaborator, then has the kernel re-check it;
- **`decide +kernel`** (Lean $\geq$ 4.15) asks the kernel alone to evaluate;
- **`native_decide`** compiles the check to machine code. It is fast, but it adds the compiler to what must be trusted. Since Lean 4.29, each such computation is recorded as its own axiom, with `_native` in its name [35].

Our strict policy accepts only kernel checks: `#print axioms` must list at most the standard axioms `propext` and `Quot.sound`. `cm.py` never emits `native_decide`. The benchmark harness tries it only after a kernel timeout, and reports such certificates in a separate, weaker category.

2.4 The problem

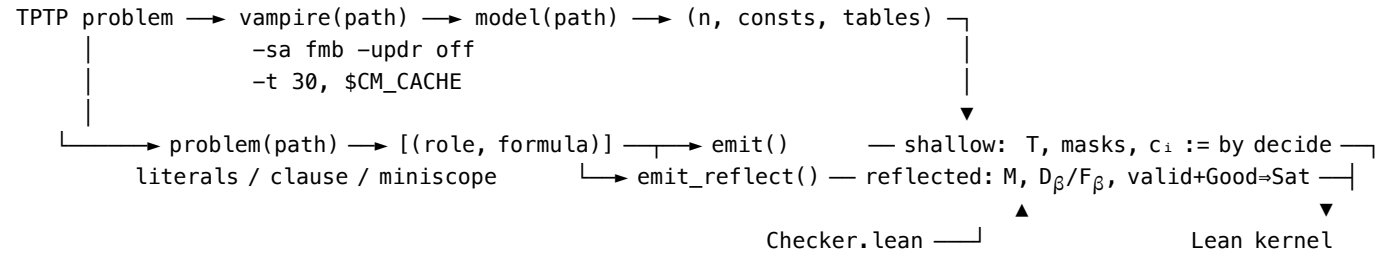
Given a TPTP problem and Vampire's finite model, produce a Lean file whose main theorem states, faithfully, that the model satisfies every axiom and falsifies the conjecture, and which **Lean's kernel accepts in reasonable time and memory**. Three difficulties make this hard:

1. **Search size.** Brute-force checking is n^v per formula: about 10^{11} for one clause in our benchmark.
2. **Elaboration size.** A problem can have over a million formulas. Lean's per-declaration costs (parsing, elaboration, typeclass search, kernel type checking) dominate, and Lean 4.13 hits hard limits: kernel recursion depth, and declarations per file.
3. **Fidelity.** Every rewrite that makes checking fast is trusted code. A wrong rewrite can make Lean certify a statement *other than* the intended one, and we observed exactly that (§5).

3. Method: Find, Rewrite, Compile, Certify

`cm.py` turns a TPTP problem (`fof` or `cnf`) into a Lean 4 proof that a finite structure satisfies `axioms ∧ ¬conjecture`. An untrusted search finds the structure; a Python translation states the claim; Lean's kernel checks it.

3.1 Pipeline



3.2 Find: `vampire(path)`

`vampire` runs `$VAMPIRE` (default `vampire`) with `-sa fmb -updr off -t 30`: the finite-model-building saturation algorithm, a 30 s limit, and unused-predicate-definition removal disabled. Without `-updr off`, Vampire may settle a problem by deleting unused predicates and print no model.

If `$CM_CACHE` is set, the output is stored under `sha256(problem bytes ‖ flags ‖ vampire --version)`. A cache hit skips Vampire entirely, so a Lean upgrade reruns only Lean. Output containing `Time limit` is never written to the cache: a timeout reflects machine load, not the problem.

3.3 Model parse: `model(path)`

`model` returns `(n, consts, tables)`:

Field	Source in Vampire output	Python type
`n`	count of `declare_$i<k>` lines	`int`
`consts`	`tff(<c>_definition, axiom, c = 'fmb_$i_k')` → element `k`; `tff(<p>_definition, axiom, (~)p)` → `bool`	`{name: int | bool}`
`tables`	each `(~)f('fmb_$i_…', …) (= 'fmb_$i_k'); = k` makes a function entry, a bare (negated) atom a predicate entry	`{symbol: {args tuple: int | bool}}`

Elements are numbered `1 … n` as Vampire prints them. If the output has no `FiniteModel`, `model` exits with `no finite counter-model found`; for a theorem this is the correct outcome (`test_a_theorem_has_no_counter_model`).

Lexing is shared by every stage: `TOKENS` treats a quoted name `'…'` (including escaped quotes and `%`) as one token, and `uncomment` strips `%` comments only outside quoted names.

3.4 Rewrite: `problem`, `literals`, `clause`, `miniscope`

`decide` and the reflected evaluator both evaluate bounded ∀ and ∨ lazily. A clause with v variables over n elements has n^v cases unless a false literal prunes its subtree. The rewrite moves each quantifier as close as possible to the first literal that uses its variable.

`problem(path)` returns `[(role, formula)]`. For each annotated formula it calls `literals(f, cnf)`, which calls `clause(tokens, scope)` to flatten the formula into `(scope, disjuncts)`. The result is rewritten by `miniscope(scope, lits)` when the formula is `cnf`, or when it is `fof`, has a non-empty scope, and flattens into more than one literal. Every other formula is kept verbatim.

`clause` rules (applied recursively, on tokens; `unwrap` drops enclosing parentheses, `split` splits at a top-level operator):

Input shape	Output	Condition	Equivalence used
`! [X̄] : B`	`clause(B, scope ∪ X̄)`	`B` contains no top-level binary operator, and `X̄ ∩ scope = ∅`	$\forall\bar{X}\ B$ is $\forall\bar{X}\ B$; the variables become part of the clause's universal prefix
A_1 `&` … `&` A_k `=>` `B`	$[\neg A_1, \ldots, \neg A_k]$ `++ clause(B)`	top-level `=>`	$A \to (B \to C) \leftrightarrow (A \wedge B) \to C \leftrightarrow \neg A \vee \neg B \vee C$
D_1 `|` … `|` D_k	`clause(`D_1`) ++ … ++ clause(`D_k`)`	top-level `|`	associativity of $\vee$
anything else	one literal	—	—

Two side conditions carry the soundness of the flattening.

1. **TPTP binding.** In TPTP, `! [X] : A => B` parses as `(∀X A) → B`: the quantifier binds only the unit that follows it. `clause` pulls ∀ out only when its body `B` is a single unit (`whole`: no top-level `&`, `|`, `=>`, `<=>`). An earlier version read `! [X] : A => B` as $\forall X\,(A \to B)$; on three TPTP problems the altered formula still held, and Lean certified a different statement (README §5). The regression is covered by `examples/quantifier_scope.p`.
2. **Fresh variables only.** A quantifier is pulled into the clause's prefix only if none of its variables is already in `scope`. Pulling a re-bound `X` out would capture occurrences of an outer `X`. When the condition fails, the subformula stays one literal with its own quantifier.

Pulling $\forall\bar{X}$ out of a disjunct is sound because, under the freshness condition, $\bar{X}$ does not occur in the other disjuncts: $A \vee \forall X\ B \leftrightarrow \forall X\,(A \vee B)$ for $X \notin \mathrm{FV}(A)$.

For `cnf`, `literals` starts with `scope = VARS(f)`: the clause's free variables are implicitly universal. `VARS` collects `[A-Z]\w*` identifiers after deleting quoted names, so `'X'` is never a variable.

`miniscope(scope, lits, bound)` rebuilds the clause as nested quantified disjunctions:

```
miniscope(scope, lits, bound):
    lit  := argmin over lits of |(VARS(l) ∩ scope) \ bound|      -- greedy: fewest new variables first
    body := lit                          if lits = [lit]
            (lit | miniscope(scope, lits \ lit, bound ∪ new(lit)))   otherwise
    return ![new(lit)]: body  if new(lit) ≠ ∅  else body
```

Each variable is bound immediately before the first literal that uses it, via $\forall X\,(A \vee B) \leftrightarrow A \vee \forall X\ B$ when $X \notin \mathrm{FV}(A)$. The greedy order chooses the literal that introduces the fewest new variables, so selective guards come first and lazy evaluation prunes early. Each literal is parenthesized by `literals`, because `![Z]: A <=> B` would otherwise bind only `A`.

3.5 Compile (shallow): `emit`

`emit(path, n, consts, tables)` produces a self-contained Lean file:

Model part	Lean form
Universe	`inductive T | e1 | … | en deriving DecidableEq`, `T.all`, `T.mem`, `T.idx`, and `Decidable (∀ x, p x)` / `Decidable (∃ x, p x)` instances via `decidable_of_iff` over `T.all`
Constant `c`	`abbrev «c» : T := T.ek`
Propositional symbol `p`	`abbrev «p» : Prop := True | False`
Predicate `p` of arity k	`abbrev «p» (x0 … x(k−1) : T) : Prop := (MASK >>> (1 * x0.idx + n * x1.idx + …)) % 2 = 1`
Function `f`	`def «f» : T → … → T` by a pattern-matching table
Formula i (from `lean(f)`)	`theorem c<i> : <`φ_i`> := by decide`; a conjecture is emitted as $\neg\varphi$

Model part	Lean form
Whole claim	`theorem countermodel : <tree of ∧> := <tree of ⟨_, _⟩>`

`tree(xs, pair)` builds balanced conjunctions and anonymous-constructor proofs: depth $\log_2 m$ instead of m, since a chain of 10,000 ∧ overflows the kernel. One theorem per formula gives each `decide` fresh caches.

Every generated file starts with `set_option autoImplicit false`: an unbound name is an elaboration error, never a silently added implicit argument. `sym(k)` writes a TPTP symbol as «k» if it matches `[a-z]\w*`, and as «'k'» otherwise. Quoted names keep their quotes, so a constant `'X'` becomes «'X'» and cannot be captured by a bound variable `X`, and `'T'` cannot collide with the type `T` (`examples/quoted_capture.p`, `examples/quoted_names.p`).

Modular output. If the problem has more than `CM_CHUNK` formulas (default 2000), `emit` returns a dict of modules instead of one string:

Module	Contents
`Base`	options, `T`, instances, predicate and function tables
`Names<k>`	constant `abbrevs`, `CM_CHUNK × 5` (10,000 by default) per module
`Chunk<j>`	`def P<i> : Prop := φᵢ`, `theorem c<i> : P<i> := by unfold P<i>; decide`, `def C<j>` (balanced ∧ of its `P<i>`), `theorem chunk<j> : C<j>`
`Main`	`theorem countermodel : <tree of C<j>>`

Constants live in separate `Names` modules because Lean 4.13 fails with "deep recursion" on files with more than about 20,000 declarations (comment in `emit`). No module restates the whole problem, and `lake` checks chunks in parallel.

3.6 Compile (reflected): `emit_reflect`

`emit_reflect(path, n, consts, tables)` does not state formulas as Lean propositions. It writes the model as a `CM.Model` with packed tables, writes the problem as packed natural numbers, and proves each block with one `decide +kernel` call through the verified evaluator in `Checker.lean` (§4).

- `tokens(f, ids)` translates a formula into the prefix token stream read by `CM.decode`. Variables become de Bruijn indices (`env.index(k)`, last-bound variable at index 0). Symbols become numbers via `ids = {"pred", "fn", "const"}`, assigned in sorted name order; propositional symbols are numbered after the table predicates, as 0-ary predicates. A conjecture is prefixed with opcode `4` (¬).
- `as_fact(toks)` recognizes ground literals `(¬)p(c₁, …, cₖ)` over constants and returns `(polarity, predicate, [constant ids])`. Facts go into fixed-width fact tables (`F<j>`, 128 per block, proved by `holds_facts`); all other formulas go into token blocks (`D<b>`, about 4096 tokens per block, proved by `holds_of_check`).
- Lookups in the generated `M`: predicates are one packed mask per symbol, read by `get (get MASKS p mw) (index n args) 1 == 1`; constants are packed 4096 per block, the block chosen by `bsearch`, a balanced tree of `if c / 4096 < k` comparisons; functions are selected by `bsearch` over function ids, then read with `get … (index n args) w`.
- The certificate proves `valid : M.valid fns = true` and `good : Good M fns problem` (well-formedness and truth, a balanced tree of `good_append` over the blocks), and states `theorem countermodel : ∀ φ ∈ problem, φ.Sat (M.toStructure …) ⟨0, …⟩ []`: ordinary first-order satisfaction (§4.4). Above 32 blocks (`per_part`) the output is split into `Base`, `Part<k>` and `Main` modules.

`bench.py`'s `run_hybrid` chooses reflection when the share of ground-literal formulas (`fact_share`) is at least 0.9, and the shallow path otherwise.

3.7 Certify

The kernel checks every `decide` (shallow) or `decide +kernel` (reflected) proof. `native_decide` is never emitted by `cm.py`; `bench.py` tries it only as a fallback after a shallow `decide` timeout and reports such problems separately as `certified (native)`.

3.8 Trust boundary

Stage	Code	Trusted?	Why / how it is checked
Find	Vampire	**No**	A wrong model makes `decide` fail. Mutation tests confirm that Lean rejects broken models.
Cache	`vampire()`, `$CM_CACHE`	**No**	It returns Vampire's output for an identical problem, flag set and version; the output is untrusted anyway.
Model parse	`model()`	**No**, for reflected certificates	A misparse that leaves the domain is caught: `Model.valid` (non-empty domain, functions closed) and `Fm.wf` (constants in range, bound variables, checked arities) are kernel-checked parts of every reflected certificate. A misparse that stays in the domain yields a different structure. Lean then certifies that structure if, and only if, it satisfies the formulas. For shallow certificates the model is a Lean inductive type and is valid by construction.
Rewrite	`problem`, `clause`, `literals`, `miniscope`	**Yes**	A non-equivalent rewrite changes what is certified. Tested by `test_rewriting_preserves_meaning` and regression examples.
Translation (shallow)	`lean()`, `sym()`, `emit()`	**Yes**	The Lean statement must mean the TPTP formula. Tested by the independent evaluator and by mutant agreement; the statement is readable in the `.lean` file.
Translation (reflected)	`tokens()`, `as_fact()`, symbol numbering	**Yes**	The `Fm` data must mean the TPTP formula. Tested by `test_reflected_mutants_agree_with_p` against an evaluator of the *original* formulas; `#eval problem` is a diagnostic that prints the decoded data (with numeric symbol ids), not a fidelity proof. The certified formulas.

Stage	Code	Trusted?	Why / how it is checked
Evaluator and semantics	`Checker.lean` (`Fm.check`, `decode`, `fact`, `Model.valid`, `Fm.wf`)	**No** (proved)	`check_iff` (evaluator = bounded semantics) and `sem_iff_sat` (bounded semantics = ordinary satisfaction, for valid models and well-formed formulas) are kernel-checked theorems; `countermodel_of_good` combines them.
Certify	Lean kernel	**Yes**	Axioms: `propext` (shallow); `propext`, `Quot.sound` (reflected, per `bench/nlp263-reflected-lean4.35.json`).

3.9 Worked example: `transitive_cnf`

Input (`examples/transitive_cnf.p`):

```
cnf(transitive, axiom, ~ r(X,Y) | ~ r(Y,Z) | r(X,Z)).
cnf(a_before_b, axiom, r(a,b)).
cnf(not_symmetric, negated_conjecture, ~ r(b,a)).
```

`problem` rewrites the first clause. `scope = {X, Y, Z}`; all three literals introduce two new variables, so `min` takes the first, `~r(X,Y)`, binding `X, Y`; then `~r(Y,Z)` introduces only `Z`:

```
![X,Y]: ((~ r ( X , Y )) | ![Z]: ((~ r ( Y , Z )) | (r ( X , Z ))))
```

Vampire returns a 2-element model: `a = 1`, `b = 2`, and `r` true only at `(1, 2)`. `emit` encodes `r` as mask `4 = 2^(0 + 2·1)`, bit index `x0.idx + 2·x1.idx`. Generated `Cm/transitive_cnf.lean` (excerpt):

```
inductive T | e1 | e2
  deriving DecidableEq
...
abbrev «a» : T := T.e1
abbrev «b» : T := T.e2
abbrev «r» (x0 x1 : T) : Prop := (4 >>> (1 * x0.idx + 2 * x1.idx)) % 2 = 1

theorem c0 : (∀ X' Y' : T, (¬(«r» X' Y') ∨ (∀ Z' : T, (¬(«r» Y' Z') ∨ («r» X' Z'))))) := by decide
theorem c1 : («r» «a» «b») := by decide
theorem c2 : ¬(«r» «b» «a») := by decide

theorem countermodel : (((∀ X' Y' : T, (¬(«r» X' Y') ∨ (∀ Z' : T, (¬(«r» Y' Z') ∨ («r» X' Z'))))))) ∧
    ((((«r» «a» «b»)) ∧ (¬(«r» «b» «a»)))) :=
  ⟨c0, ⟨c1, c2⟩⟩
```

TPTP variables are emitted primed (`X` becomes `X'`). A TPTP variable cannot contain `'`, so no variable can shadow the domain type `T` or a Lean constant such as `True`.

In the reflected path, with `ids = {pred: {r: 0}, const: {a: 0, b: 1}}`, `tokens` produces:

Formula	Tokens	Route
transitive	`9 9 6 4 0 0 2 0 1 0 0 9 6 4 0 0 2 0 1 0 0 0 0 2 0 2 0 0`	token block `D0`
`r(a,b)`	`0 0 2 1 0 1 1` → `as_fact = (1, 0, [0, 1])`	fact table `F0`

Formula	Tokens	Route
`~r(b,a)`	`4 0 0 2 1 1 1 0` → `as_fact = (0, 0, [1, 0])`	fact table `F0`

Reading the first stream: `9 9` is ∀∀, `6` is ∨, `4 0 0 2 (0 1) (0 0)` is ¬r(var 1, var 0), i.e. ¬r(X, Y), because `Y`, bound last, is index 0.

`group_comm.p` illustrates the other branch of `problem`: each `fof` formula there is a single equation under one `!`, so `clause` yields one literal, the `ok` test fails, and the formula is emitted unchanged, e.g. `theorem c3 : ¬(∀ X' Y' : T, ((«mul» X' Y') = («mul» Y' X'))) := by decide` over the 6-element model S_3.

3.10 Independent checks (`test_cm.py`)

The trusted Python stages are tested against an evaluator that shares only the lexer (`TOKENS`) with `cm.py`. Tests that need Vampire and `lake` are skipped when either is missing.

Test	What it checks
`holds(s, n, consts, tables, env)`	Not a test: a brute-force evaluator of the **original** TPTP text. It parses with its own recursive descent and evaluates `!/?` with `itertools.product` over `1 … n`. It never sees `lean()`, `tokens()` or `Checker.lean`.
`countermodel(path, …)`	Python's verdict: every formula of `problem(path)` holds, except the conjecture, which fails.
`test_compiles_to_committed_file`, `test_reflects_to_committed_file`	`cm.py` output equals the committed `Cm/<name>.lean` (shallow) and `Refl/<name>.lean` (reflected), for each of the 15 `examples/*.p`.
`test_kernel_accepts_with_propext_only`	`lake build` succeeds and every line of `#print axioms` (via `Axioms.lean`) ends with `[propext]`.
`test_python_agrees_it_is_a_countermodel`	`holds` confirms Vampire's model for every example.
`test_circle_of_fifths_is_the_known_answer`	The model has exactly 12 elements, and `f` and `g` are x ↦ x+7 and x ↦ x+5 (mod 12).
`test_mutants_lean_and_python_agree`	Two random one-entry corruptions per example (seed 0): Lean (shallow) accepts **exactly** the mutants that `holds` accepts, and at least one mutant is rejected.
`test_reflected_mutants_agree_with_python`	Same, seed 1, through `emit_reflect` and `Checker.lean`. This tests the reflected translation, the trusted part of that path.
`test_reflected_certificate`	Each example's model certifies through `emit_reflect`.
`test_rewriting_preserves_meaning`	Each rewritten formula agrees with its raw original (a `cnf` closed with `![VARS]`) under `holds`, on the model and on every one-entry mutation of every table.
`test_a_theorem_has_no_counter_model`	`cm.py` exits non-zero on `∀X p(X) ⊢ p(k)`.
`test_large_problems_split_into_modules`, `test_constants_split_into_name_modules`	With `CM_CHUNK=2` or `1`, modular output builds with `lake`; `#print axioms` on the result contains no `sorryAx`.
`test_vampire_cache_is_transparent`	With `CM_CACHE`, the second run hits the cache (one entry) and emits identical Lean.
`test_boundary_cases_are_rejected_by_the_kernel`	Builds `tests/Boundary.lean`: the reviewer's out-of-range constant passes `check` but fails `wf`; an empty domain and a leaking function fail `valid`; an unbound variable and a wrong arity fail `wf`; too little decoder fuel yields ⊥ (documented behaviour, not general truncation detection).
`test_quoted_and_plain_names_are_the_same_symbol`	`cat` and `'cat'` translate identically; `'X'` stays a constant, distinct from the variable `X`.

Test	What it checks
`test_unsupported_syntax_is_rejected_not_misread` (7 cases), `test_typed_statements_and_includes_are_rejected` (2), `test_a_symbol_at_two_arities_is_rejected`	Fail-closed parsing: `<~>`, `<=`, `~|`, `~&`, `$distinct`, numbers, strings, `tff`, `include` and mixed arities raise an error in both translators.
`test_benchmark_records_unsupported_input`	The harness classifies such inputs as *unsupported input* **before** Vampire runs (the test supplies a Vampire binary that does not exist).
`test_variables_cannot_capture_lean_names` (5 cases)	Variables named `T`, `True`, `False`, `Nat`, `Decidable` compile; `T` and `True` failed on the translator before the fix.
`test_ablation_finds_what_a_conclusion_needs`	`ablate.py` labels a needed axiom with a certified counter-model, and never labels an underivable target as needing anything.

The suite has **102 test cases**: 5 tests parametrized over the 15 examples (75), 14 rejection and capture cases, and 13 single tests. Separately, `recheck.sh` rebuilds all 30 shipped certificates, prints their axioms and replays `Checker`, `AllShallow` and `AllReflected` through the kernel from scratch with `leanchecker --fresh` (Lean 4.35); its output is `bench/recheck.log`.

Planted bugs. The suite was validated by introducing known bugs into `cm.py` and confirming failures (README §5): `=>` compiled as $\leftrightarrow$ (7 tests fail), a scoping bug (4), a dropped negation (18), a lost parenthesis (4), and the single-formula case (1). The planted variants are not in the repository; the counts are those recorded in the README, measured against the suite at that time.

4. The Verified Checker: Data Structures and Trust

`Checker.lean` (namespace `CM`, 214 lines) is the evaluator behind the reflected path (§3.6). It defines first-order syntax as data, a Tarski semantics `Fm.Sem`, a Boolean evaluator `Fm.check`, one equivalence theorem `Fm.check_iff`, and decoders from packed natural numbers to formulas. A reflected certificate is one kernel evaluation of `check` per block, not one elaborated proposition per formula.

4.1 Data structures

Syntax is plain inductive data, with de Bruijn variables:

```
inductive Tm where
  | var (i : Nat)
  | const (c : Nat)
  | app (f : Nat) (args : List Tm)

inductive Fm where
  | atom (p : Nat) (args : List Tm)
  | eq (a b : Tm)
  | tru | fls
  | not (φ : Fm)
  | and (φ ψ : Fm) | or (φ ψ : Fm) | imp (φ ψ : Fm) | iff (φ ψ : Fm)
  | all (φ : Fm) | ex (φ : Fm)
  deriving Repr
```

A model is a domain size and three lookup functions. Elements are `0 … n−1`:

```
structure Model where
  n : Nat
  const : Nat → Nat
  fn : Nat → List Nat → Nat
  pred : Nat → List Nat → Bool
```

Terms evaluate under an environment `env : List Nat`. Index 0 is the most recently bound variable:

```
def Tm.val (M : Model) (env : List Nat) : Tm → Nat
  | .var i => env.getD i 0
  | .const c => M.const c
  | .app f args => M.fn f (Tm.vals M env args)
def Tm.vals (M : Model) (env : List Nat) : List Tm → List Nat
  | [] => []
  | t :: ts => t.val M env :: Tm.vals M env ts
```

The semantics is a `Prop`. Quantifiers range over `x < M.n`:

```
def Fm.Sem (M : Model) : List Nat → Fm → Prop
  | env, .atom p args => M.pred p (Tm.vals M env args) = true
  | env, .eq a b => a.val M env = b.val M env
  ...
  | env, .all φ => ∀ x, x < M.n → φ.Sem M (x :: env)
  | env, .ex φ => ∃ x, x < M.n ∧ φ.Sem M (x :: env)
```

The evaluator mirrors it clause by clause in `Bool`. Bounded quantifiers become counting loops that stop at the first decisive value:

```
def allBelow (f : Nat → Bool) : Nat → Bool
  | 0 => true
  | k + 1 => f k && allBelow f k
def anyBelow (f : Nat → Bool) : Nat → Bool
  | 0 => false
  | k + 1 => f k || anyBelow f k

def Fm.check (M : Model) : List Nat → Fm → Bool
  | env, .atom p args => M.pred p (Tm.vals M env args)
  | env, .eq a b => a.val M env == b.val M env
  | env, .imp φ ψ => !φ.check M env || ψ.check M env
  ...
  | env, .all φ => allBelow (fun x => φ.check M (x :: env)) M.n
  | env, .ex φ => anyBelow (fun x => φ.check M (x :: env)) M.n
```

`allBelow` and `anyBelow` count down from `n` and build no list. Together with `&&`/`||`, they give `check` the pruning that §3.4's miniscoping relies on.

Structure	Role	Encoding	Lookup / evaluation cost
`Tm`	term syntax	inductive; `var` is a de Bruijn index	`Tm.val`: $O(\|t\|)$ model lookups; `.var i` is `env.getD i 0`, $O(i)$
`Fm`	formula syntax	inductive, 11 constructors	`Fm.check`: $O(\|\varphi\| \cdot n^{\varphi})$ worst case for quantifier nesting depth q; lazy `&&`, `||`, `allBelow`, `anyBelow` prune
`Model`	finite structure	`n` plus `const`, `fn`, `pred` as functions	cost of the function bodies (§4.2)
`Fm.Sem`	meaning (specification)	`Prop`, never evaluated	—
`allBelow` / `anyBelow`	bounded ∀ / ∃	structural recursion on `n`	≤ n calls of `f`; stops at the first `false` / `true`
`Holds M φs`	certificate statement	`∀ φ ∈ φs, φ.Sem M []`	—

4.2 Models in generated certificates

`emit_reflect` writes one `def M : Model`. Elements are shifted from Vampire's `1 … n` to `0 … n−1` (`x − 1`). Two helpers from `Checker.lean` do all lookups:

```
def get (packed i w : Nat) : Nat := (packed >>> (i * w)) % 2 ^ w   -- w-bit field i
def index (n : Nat) : List Nat → Nat                               -- tuple → position, base n
  | [] => 0
  | x :: xs => x + n * index n xs
```

The generated model, with `n`, `K = 4096`, the element width `w = max(n-1,1).bit_length()` and the mask width `mw` substituted:

```
def M : Model where
  n := n
  const c := get (if c / 4096 < k then … else …) (c % 4096) w
  fn f args := get (if f < k then … else …) (index n args) w
  pred p args := get (get MASKS p mw) (index n args) 1 == 1
```

Symbol kind	Python (`emit_reflect`)	Lean lookup	Cost in symbols
Predicate p	`masks[i]`: bit `idx(a)` set iff `p(a)` is true; propositional symbols are 0-ary predicates with mask 1 or 0; all masks packed into one Nat at width `mw`	`get (get MASKS p mw) (index n args) 1`	$O(1)$: two `get`s, one `index` (O(arity))
Constant c	`cvals` packed `w` bits each, 4096 per block (`cblocks`)	`bsearch('c / 4096', cblocks)` selects the block; `get … (c % 4096) w`	$O(\log b)$ comparisons for b blocks, then one `get`
Function f	`fn_tables[i]`: value `v-1` at field `idx(a)`, width `w`	`bsearch('f', fn_tables)`; `get … (index n args) w`	$O(\log F)$ comparisons for F functions, then one `get`

`bsearch(var, xs)` writes `xs[var]` as a balanced tree of `if var < mid` comparisons. A `match` on literals would be a chain of $O(n)$ comparisons. Each `get` is a shift of a packed Nat, and a shift costs time linear in the Nat's bit length. Blocking bounds that length (§5, pattern 13a).

4.3 Problem encodings

(a) Token streams. A block of non-fact formulas is one Nat, `D<b>`, of fixed-width tokens in prefix order. The token width is `tw = max(max token, 10).bit_length()`, at least 4 bits.

Formulas	Opcode	Operands	Terms	Opcode	Operands
atom	0	p k $t_1 \ldots t_k$	variable	0	i (de Bruijn)
=	1	t t	constant	1	c
⊤ / ⊥	2 / 3	—	application	2	f k $t_1 \ldots t_k$
¬	4	φ			
∧ ∨ → ↔	5 6 7 8	φ ψ			
∀ / ∃	9 / 10	φ			

The decoder is mutually recursive and fueled:

Function	Signature	Reads
`readTm s w`	`fuel → i → Option (Tm × Nat)`	one term at position `i`; returns the next position
`readTms s w`	`fuel → k → i → Option (List Tm × Nat)`	`k` terms
`readFm s w`	`fuel → i → Option (Fm × Nat)`	one formula
`readFms s w fuel`	`k → i → List Fm`	`k` formulas; on `none` it returns `[.fls]` and stops

Function	Signature	Reads
`decode s w k depth`	`List Fm`	`readFms s w depth k 0`

Fuel bounds the recursion depth, and each call consumes one unit. Kernel cost grows with the fuel, so `emit_reflect` passes `depth = max(map(nesting, fs)) + 2`, where `nesting` is the token count of a single formula. That is an upper bound on the nesting depth, not the block's token count (§5, pattern 13b: >9 min → 12 s). What the decoder does with bad data is precise, and narrower than "malformed data decodes to ⊥":

- **Detected failures:** if the fuel runs out, `readFm` returns `none`, and `readFms` emits `.fls`, which can never be certified.
- **Not detected by the decoder:** `get` reads zeros past the end of the data, and the formula count is supplied by the generator. So truncation, extra tokens and wrong counts can decode to *some* formula list. They do not pass silently: that list is the statement Lean certifies, so the error would be in the trusted translation.
- **Caught by `Fm.wf`:** out-of-scope variables, out-of-range constants and wrong function arities (§4.4).

`tests/Boundary.lean` records these cases as kernel-checked facts.

Illustration: `fof(irrefl, axiom, ![X]: ~ r(X,X)).` with `ids["pred"]["r"] = 0`. `tokens` returns `[9] + body`, and `X` is index 0:

```
formula :  ∀ X . ¬ r ( X , X )
tokens  :  9   4   0   0   2   0  0   0  0
           │   │   │   │   │   └──┘   └──┘
           ∀   ¬  atom p=0 k=2 var 0  var 0
position:  0   1   2   3   4   5  6   7  8

packed (tw = 4 bits, token i at bits 4i … 4i+3, least significant first):
  bits  35..32 31..28 27..24 23..20 19..16 15..12 11..8 7..4 3..0
  token   0      0      0      0      2      0      0     4    9
  D = 9 + 4·2⁴ + 2·2¹⁶ = 131145

decode 131145 4 1 11  =  [.all (.not (.atom 0 [.var 0, .var 0]))]
  (depth = 9 tokens + 2 = 11)
```

(b) Fact tables. `emit_reflect` diverts every formula that `as_fact` recognizes as a ground literal $(\neg)p(c_1,\ldots,c_k)$ over constants into fixed-width records. With K slots for the largest fact arity, each record has `K + 2` fields of `fw` bits: polarity (1 asserted, 0 denied), predicate, then K constant ids, zero-padded. A block `F<j>` holds 128 records (`facts_per_block`). The arity table `ar` is packed at width `aw = K.bit_length()`.

```
def fact (s w K : Nat) (ar : Nat → Nat) (i : Nat) : Fm :=
  let b := i * (K + 2)
  let p := get s (b + 1) w
  let a := (List.range (ar p)).map fun j => Tm.const (get s (b + 2 + j) w)
  if get s b w == 1 then .atom p a else .not (.atom p a)

def decodeFacts (s w K : Nat) (ar : Nat → Nat) (k : Nat) : List Fm := (List.range k).map (fact s w K
 ↪  ar)
```

`fact` reads record `i` directly with $O(K)$ `get`s. No general decoding and no fuel are needed.

Illustration: the facts of `transitive_cnf.p` (§3.9), with `r = 0`, `a = 0`, `b = 1`, `K = 2` and `fw = 1`:

```
record i = fields [i·4 … i·4+3]        (K + 2 = 4 fields, fw = 1 bit each)

            ┌──────────┬───────────┬────────┬────────┐
            │ polarity │ predicate │ slot 0 │ slot 1 │
            ├──────────┼───────────┼────────┼────────┤
 0: r(a,b)  │    1     │     0     │   0    │   1    │   as_fact → (1, 0, [0, 1])
 1: ~r(b,a) │    0     │     0     │   1    │   0    │   as_fact → (0, 0, [1, 0])
            └──────────┴───────────┴────────┴────────┘
```

```
 F0 = pack([1,0,0,1, 0,0,1,0], 1) = 2⁰ + 2³ + 2⁶ = 73
 ar = get 2 p 2                    (arity of r = 2, aw = 2)

theorem hf0 : Holds M (decodeFacts F0 1 2 ar 2) := holds_facts M _ _ _ _ _ (by decide +kernel)
```

4.4 Soundness

The certificate rests on two theorems, both proved once in `Checker.lean`.

(1) From bounded evaluation to ordinary semantics. `Fm.Sem` is a *bounded* semantics. Quantifiers range over `x < M.n`, but nothing in `Model` stops a constant or function value from leaving that range, and `M.n` may be 0. Peer review rightly pointed out the consequence. With `M.n = 1` and a constant interpreted as 1, the bounded semantics makes `∀x, x ≠ c` true, although it is unsatisfiable in any structure containing `c`; with `M.n = 0`, `∀x, ⊥` is vacuously true. The checker therefore defines ordinary structures and satisfaction, and two kernel-checked conditions:

```
structure Structure (α : Type) where
  const : Nat → α
  fn : Nat → List α → α
  pred : Nat → List α → Prop
def Fm.Sat (S : Structure α) (d : α) : List α → Fm → Prop  -- ∀/∃ range over all of α

def Model.valid (M : Model) (fns : List (Nat × Nat)) : Bool :=      -- 0 < n; each function closed
  0 < M.n && fns.all fun (f, k) => allTuples M.n (fun xs => M.fn f xs < M.n) k
def Fm.wf (M : Model) (fns : List (Nat × Nat)) : Nat → Fm → Bool   -- bound variables, constants in
 ↪ range,
                                                                   -- functions at checked arities
theorem sem_iff_sat (M) (fns) (hv : M.valid fns = true) (d : Fin M.n) (φ : Fm) :
    ∀ env : List (Fin M.n), φ.wf M fns env.length = true →
    (φ.Sem M (env.map Fin.val) ↔ φ.Sat (M.toStructure (Model.valid_pos hv)) d env)
```

`M.toStructure` is the structure on `Fin M.n` that `M` describes. Its values are clipped into the domain, and the proof shows the clipping never changes a value for valid models and well-formed terms (`val_interp`). For a closed formula (`env = []`), **the bounded semantics coincides with ordinary first-order satisfaction.** The reviewer's examples are rejected: `allNeC.wf Out [] 0 = false` and `EmptyDomain.valid [] = false` are kernel-checked in `tests/Boundary.lean`.

(2) The evaluator decides the bounded semantics:

One theorem connects the evaluator to the semantics. It is proved once, by induction on `Fm`, and holds for every formula and every model:

```
theorem Fm.check_iff (M : Model) (φ : Fm) : ∀ env, φ.check M env = true ↔ φ.Sem M env
```

What a certificate states. Each block is checked in one pass, `φ.wf M fns 0 && φ.check M []`, giving `Good M fns block` (`good_of_check`, `good_facts`). Blocks combine with `good_append`, `M.valid fns` is one more `decide +kernel`, and `countermodel_of_good` concludes:

```
theorem countermodel : ∀ φ ∈ problem, φ.Sat (M.toStructure (Model.valid_pos valid)) ⟨0,
 ↪  Model.valid_pos valid⟩ [] :=
  countermodel_of_good M fns problem valid good
-- #check @transitive_cnf.countermodel (generated from examples/transitive_cnf.p):
--   ∀ (φ : Fm), φ ∈ transitive_cnf.problem → Fm.Sat (transitive_cnf.M.toStructure …) ⟨0, …⟩ [] φ
-- @Fm.Sat : {α : Type} → Structure α → α → List α → Fm → Prop   (dot notation places φ last)
```

That is: **the ordinary first-order structure on `Fin n` satisfies every formula of the decoded problem.** What it does *not* state is that the decoded problem is the TPTP source; that is the trusted translation (§3.8).

The `atom` case is `rfl`. The propositional cases are `simp` with the induction hypotheses, and `imp` adds a case split on `φ.check M env`. The quantifier cases use

```
theorem allBelow_iff (f : Nat → Bool) : ∀ n, allBelow f n = true ↔ ∀ x, x < n → f x = true
theorem anyBelow_iff (f : Nat → Bool) : ∀ n, anyBelow f n = true ↔ ∃ x, x < n ∧ f x = true
```

each proved by recursion on `n`. Three lemmas lift `check_iff` to certificates:

Lemma	Hypothesis (closed by `decide +kernel`)	Conclusion
`holds_of_check M φs`	`φs.all (·.check M []) = true`	`Holds M φs`
`holds_facts M s w K ar k`	`(List.range k).all (fun i => (fact s w K ar i).check M []) = true`	`Holds M (decodeFacts s w K ar k)`
`holds_append`	`Holds M a`, `Holds M b`	`Holds M (a ++ b)`

These truth-only lemmas are the inner layer of `good_of_check`, `good_facts` and `good_append`, which add the well-formedness conjunct. In the generated certificate, `problem : List Fm` is a balanced `++` tree of the `decode D<b> …` and `decodeFacts F<j> …` blocks, a conjecture appears negated (opcode 4), and `good : Good M fns problem` is a balanced tree of `good_append` over the per-block proofs `h<b>` and `hf<j>`; the public statement is `countermodel` above. NLP263+1's reflected certificate depends on the axioms `propext` and `Quot.sound` only. `#print axioms` on the library pins down where `Quot.sound` enters: through `allBelow_iff` and `anyBelow_iff`, the lemmas for the quantifier loops. `check_iff`, `holds_of_check` and `holds_facts` inherit it from them, and `holds_append` needs only `propext`. Both are standard Lean axioms, used throughout Mathlib.

Fidelity, and its limit. `decode`, `decodeFacts` and `M` are ordinary Lean definitions, so `#eval problem` prints the list of formulas the certificate is about. That is a useful diagnostic, not a proof of fidelity. It shows numeric symbol ids, so comparing it with the TPTP source needs the generator's symbol map and the rewrite. And `#eval` runs compiled code, so it adds nothing to the kernel proof. Fidelity to the source therefore rests on the trusted, tested translation (§3.8): a *verified checker* with a *tested translation pipeline*, not a verified TPTP-to-Lean compiler.

4.5 Shallow vs reflected certificates

	Shallow (`emit`, §3.5)	Reflected (`emit_reflect`)
Statement form	one Lean `Prop` per formula over `inductive T`; `theorem c<i> : φᵢ := by decide`	ordinary satisfaction `φ.Sat (M.toStructure …)` for every φ in `problem`, over `Fm` data
Trusted code	`lean()`, `sym()`, `emit()`, rewriter, kernel	`tokens()`, `as_fact()`, symbol numbering, rewriter, kernel. `Checker.lean` is proved, and `#eval problem` exposes the statement
Per-formula cost	parse + elaborate + typeclass search + `decide` for each formula	no per-formula elaboration: one Nat literal per block, evaluated by `decide +kernel`
Axioms	`propext` (examples)	`propext`, `Quot.sound`
Best use	quantifier-heavy problems	fact-heavy problems

Measured (8 GB laptop, 8 cores):

Workload	Shallow	Reflected
10,000-fact slice, Lean 4.35, median of 3 (§6.3.1)	31.1 s CPU	**9.8 s CPU**
NLP263+1, 1,026,857 facts, Lean 4.35, median of 3 (§6.3.1)	14.1 min wall	**5.2 min** wall
PLA025+1, quantifier-heavy, 10-element model, Lean 4.35	**4.4 s**	>400 s (did not finish); 228 s with the evaluator written using the primitive recursor

Reflection wins on ground facts and loses badly on nested quantifiers. *Hypothesis:* lazy kernel evaluation re-decodes subformulas inside the `allBelow`/`anyBelow` loops, because the `decode …` term is unfolded under each quantifier instead

of being shared. *Policy:* hybrid dispatch. `bench.py`'s `run_hybrid` reflects when `fact_share ≥ 0.9` and uses the shallow method otherwise. *Future work:* decode once and check the result. That means proving `decode D … = L` for an explicit list `L`, then running `check` on `L`, so that quantifier loops never touch the packed stream.

4.6 Independent checks of the reflected path (`test_cm.py`)

The reflected path trusts the encoder, not the evaluator. Two tests target it, both against `holds`, a brute-force evaluator of the original TPTP text that shares only `TOKENS` with `cm.py`.

Test	Check
`test_reflected_certificate`	`lake build Checker` succeeds, and for every `examples/*.p` the `emit_reflect` output is accepted by `lake env lean`.
`test_reflected_mutants_agree_with_python`	Two random one-entry corruptions per example (seed 1): a predicate entry is flipped, or a function entry is changed to a different element. The list of reflected Lean verdicts must equal `[countermodel(p, *m) …]`. Lean accepts **exactly** the mutants that Python accepts, and `not all(lean)` ensures that some mutant is rejected.

A wrong translation in `tokens` or `as_fact` would certify a formula other than the TPTP one. The mutant test exposes this whenever a corrupted model separates the two formulas, which is why its docstring calls it a check on "the part of the reflected path that is trusted".

5. Scaling: Design Patterns, Data Structures and Measured Effects

Central lesson, for the workloads we measured. For our large ground-fact certificates, the cost was dominated by Lean *elaborating statements* (parsing, elaboration, typeclass search, kernel type checking of large terms) rather than by evaluating them, and reducing proposition elaboration gave the largest gains. This is not a claim about all Lean certificates: quantifier-heavy checking has a separate evaluation bottleneck, which our own reflected regression on PLA025+1 shows (§4.5).

Cost model. Unless stated otherwise, $O(\cdot)$ counts field operations (shifts, masks, comparisons) on fixed-width fields. On `Nat` data, a shift costs time proportional to the bit length of the number shifted. That is why blocking (pattern 13a) matters, and why an "$O(1)$ packed lookup" means a constant number of operations on a bounded block, not constant time on an unbounded table.

Profile of one 2,000-fact shallow chunk (Lean 4.13):

Phase	Time	Share
Parsing	3.83 s	41%
Tactic execution	1.37 s	15%
Elaboration	1.34 s	14%
Kernel type checking	1.08 s	12%
Typeclass inference	1.04 s	11%
Other (definitions, linting, sharing, metavariables)	0.59 s	6%
Total	**9.25 s**	100%

Parsing alone outweighs tactic execution (where `decide` actually runs) by 2.8×. Together, parsing, elaboration and typeclass inference take 66% of the chunk's time, against 15% for running the tactics.

Machine for all measurements: 8 GB laptop, 8 cores.

5.1 Master table

#	Pattern (classic name)	Where applied	Big-O before → after	Measured effect	Status
1	Backtracking with pruning (miniscoping; lazy ∨, bounded ∀ in `decide`)	clause evaluation	$\|M\|^k$ full enumeration → pruned search tree	NLP219-1: 13-var clause over 7 elements $\approx 10^{11}$ cases → 46,746 atom checks for the whole problem; impossible → certified	kept
2	Greedy join ordering (fewest new variables first)	literal order inside a clause	— (heuristic)	a heuristic, not a guarantee of picking the most selective literal (the density planner, R1, shows selectivity is data-dependent); on SWB017+3 it happens to start from a highly selective guard, `rest(S3, nil)`	kept
3	Loop fusion / deforestation (recursive flattening ∀V(A→∀W(B→C)) → one clause, fresh vars only)	FOF → clause translation	nested loops re-enter outer guards → one fused loop	SWB017+3 368,112 → 5,932 atom checks; `native_decide` → kernel-only `decide` in 2–12 s. PLA025+1 91,921 → 31,675	kept
4	Bitset (bitmask predicate tables)	model predicate lookup	$O(n)$ list-membership scan → $O(1)$ bit test	NLP165-1 10.9 s → ~1 s	kept
5	Divide and conquer (one theorem per formula)	certificate layout	one monolithic term → n small independent terms	PLA025+1 47 s → 14 s; peak memory 805 MB → 420 MB	kept
6	Memoization (VARS cache of literal variables)	Python rewriter	recompute per visit → once per literal	SYN832-1 rewrite 21.8 s → 8.4 s, identical output	kept
7	Balanced binary tree	conjunction terms	depth $O(n)$ → $O(\log_2 n)$	linear 10,000-way ∧ overflows kernel ("deep recursion"); tree passes	kept

#	Pattern (classic name)	Where applied	Big-O before → after	Measured effect	Status
8	Partitioning / sharding (≤10,000 declarations per module)	Lean modules	— (hard limit)	an observed, reproducible failure point on Lean 4.13 for our generated pattern: files with more than ~20,600 declarations fail ("deep recursion"); not re-tested on 4.35; Names split for 383,180 constants	kept
9	Segment tree / map-reduce (hierarchical aggregation)	final theorem	restate n formulas in Main → $O(n/\text{chunk})$ chunk conjunctions	10,000-formula slice 109 s → 12.3 s wall; Main 77 s → 0.09 s	kept
10	Content-addressed cache (SHA-256 of problem+flags+version)	Vampire calls	re-run per invocation → $O(1)$ hit	on a Lean-only rerun, every problem with a deterministic Vampire answer (77 models and 3 definite give-ups) is served from the cache; the 2026-10-15 rerun's median end-to-end time fell from 3 s to 0.65 s per problem; timeouts never cached	kept
11	Index lookup instead of rejection sampling	benchmark selection	~113 requests/problem → 1–2	picking ~165 s → negligible; end-to-end ~174 s → ~8 s per problem (~22×)	kept
12	Producer–consumer pipeline, memory-sized worker pool, fail-fast, LPT scheduling	build orchestration	— (makespan)	~600 MB per chunk → 3–4 workers on 8 GB; `native_decide` only after timeout; LPT ordering was not measured in isolation	kept

#	Pattern (classic name)	Where applied	Big-O before → after	Measured effect	Status
13	Reflection (verified evaluator `Checker.lean`) with compact encoding	ground-fact certificates	elaborate n propositions → elaborate one data literal + one evaluator	10,000-fact slice (Lean 4.35): 36.1 s → 5.1 s CPU (7.1×)	kept (hybrid)
13a	Square-root decomposition / blocking (packed Nat per block)	reflected data encoding	lookup in one 557,591-bit number $O(N)$ per shift ($O(N^2)$ total) → O(block)	unblocked packing quadratic; array literal of 11,312 numbers timed out in elaboration	kept
13b	Fuel = nesting depth instead of token count	reflected evaluator	kernel cost grows with fuel → bounded by depth	>9 min → 12 s	kept
13c	Direct addressing / binary search instead of `match` chains	reflected predicate and constant lookup	$O(n)$ literal comparison chain → $O(1)$ packed lookup, $O(\log n)$ blocks	10.4 → 8.5 s CPU	kept
13d	Fixed-width records (fact tables)	reflected facts	—	8.5 → 5.66 s CPU	kept
13e	Block-size tuning	reflected facts	—	128: 5.11 s, 512: 5.66 s, 2048: 7.68 s CPU	kept (128)
13f	`decide +kernel` instead of `decide`	reflected proof	skip elaborator-side evaluation	prototype 7.0 s → 3.1 s	kept
R1	Cost-based query planner (order by model table density)	literal order	—	PLA025 −24% atom checks; NLP219 +14%	rejected
R2	Hash-consing (memoized fact lemmas per equivalence class)	shallow facts	9,957 facts → 27 lemmas	build 38.8 s vs 12.3 s (3× slower)	rejected
R3	Opaque `def` vs `abbrev` for named propositions	shallow statements	—	no effect	rejected
R4	`rfl` instead of `decide` for positive facts	shallow facts	—	6.75 → 5.12 s (1.3×)	measured, not adopted: superseded by reflection
R5	Short-name interning	constant names	—	not measured	untested

#	Pattern (classic name)	Where applied	Big-O before → after	Measured effect	Status
R6	Reflection for quantifier-heavy problems	PLA025+1 (10-element model)	—	>400 s (did not finish) vs 4.4 s shallow; primitive recursor 228 s	rejected → hybrid dispatch

5.2 Patterns grouped by the cost they attack

Search size (patterns 1–3, R1). Search size grows as $|M|^k$ in the number of variables k. Backtracking with miniscoping, lazy $\vee$ and bounded $\forall$ cuts NLP219-1 from a $\approx 10^{11}$-case clause to 46,746 atom checks for the whole problem. Greedy join order starts each search at the most selective guard. Recursive flattening fuses nested guarded quantifiers into one clause that introduces only fresh variables. Without it, the inner loop re-evaluates outer guards. This alone moved SWB017+3 from `native_decide` to kernel-only `decide`. Once search was this small, it stopped dominating the cost.

Elaboration (patterns 5, 9, 13, R2). These attack the cost that dominates in the profile. Splitting into one theorem per formula keeps each elaboration problem small: PLA025+1 47 s → 14 s, with peak memory halved. Hierarchical aggregation removes the second elaboration of every formula in Main. Restating 10,000 formulas in one final theorem took 77 s, of which the statement alone took 59 s and an explicit `And.intro` term 237 s. Reflection removes per-formula elaboration entirely. The certificate becomes data (packed Nat literals) plus one verified evaluator `Checker.lean`, run with `decide +kernel`. Hash-consing failed for the opposite reason: it *added* unification of each fact against a shared lemma (R2).

Kernel limits (patterns 7, 8, 13a–13c). These are hard limits rather than costs: Lean either works or fails.

- A right-nested $\wedge$ of 10,000 conjuncts fails with "deep recursion". A balanced tree has depth $\lceil \log_2 n \rceil$.
- **On Lean 4.13, with our generated pattern and default options**, files with more than about 20,600 declarations failed with kernel "deep recursion". Even 30,000 trivial `def c_i : Nat := 1` fail, in a band of ~340 failures around declaration 20,600. The fix caps modules at 10,000 declarations.
- In the reflected path, kernel evaluation is sensitive to representation.
  - A 557,591-bit number shifted on every lookup made decoding quadratic. Blocking fixed it.
  - Structural recursion on fuel = token count made evaluation take more than 9 min. Fuel = nesting depth: 12 s.
  - `match` on literals compiles to an $O(n)$ comparison chain. Packed $O(1)$ lookup and binary search over constant blocks replaced it.

Memory and I/O (patterns 4, 5, 6, 13d–13e). Bitmask tables replace list scans (NLP165-1 10.9 s → ~1 s). Each chunk needs ~600 MB, which caps parallelism on 8 GB. Divide and conquer halved peak memory on PLA025+1. Reflection shrank NLP263+1 from 178 MB of source to 25 MB and from 2.0 GB of build output to 65 MB (Table 5.3). Fixed-width fact records with 128 facts per block gave the lowest reflected CPU time.

Pipeline throughput (patterns 10–12). These patterns reduce the time spent outside Lean.

- **Vampire cache.** Keyed by SHA-256(problem, flags, version). Timeouts are never cached, because two problems flipped from model to timeout under CPU load. **Note:** the lower median time of reruns (0.65 s against 3 s per problem) reflects cache reuse, not a Lean improvement.
- **Benchmark selection.** It reads the TPTP ProblemAndSolutionStatistics index: 2,561 eligible problems of 26,990 (CNF SAT 1,305; FOF CSA 888; FOF SAT 368). Rejection sampling took ~113 requests per problem; the index needs 1–2.
- **Build pipeline.** A producer–consumer pipeline, with the worker pool sized by memory (3–4 workers). Jobs run longest first (LPT) to shorten the makespan. `native_decide` runs only after a `decide` timeout, so kernel-only proofs remain the default.

5.3 NLP263+1: shallow vs reflected

NLP263+1: 1,026,857 ground facts, 383,180 constants, 1-element model. Sources: `bench/nlp263-lean4.13.json`, `bench/nlp263-reflected-lean4.35.json`.

Historical, uncontrolled measurements. This subsection records the development-time runs: single runs, different Lean versions, different worker counts, varying load, and a reflected certificate *without* the validity and well-formedness checks added after peer review. They explain how the design was reached; they are **not** the paper's performance claim. The controlled comparison is §6.3.1 (median 14.1 min shallow against 5.2 min reflected, 2.7×).

Metric	Shallow (Lean 4.13)	Reflected (Lean 4.35)	Ratio
Wall time	20.7 min (1,241 s)	4.8 min (290 s)	4.3×
CPU time	54 min (3,262 s)	17.5 min (1,052 s)	3.1×
Peak memory	1.64 GB	0.50 GB	3.3×
Lean source	178 MB	25 MB	7.1×
Build output	2.0 GB	65 MB	~31×
Modules	555 (Base 1, Names 39, Chunk 514, Main 1)	253 (Base 1, Part 251, Main 1)	2.2×
Granularity	2,000 facts/chunk, 3 parallel	128 facts/block, 32 blocks/part, 4 parallel	—
Axioms	none	`propext`, `Quot.sound`	—
Failed modules	0	0	—

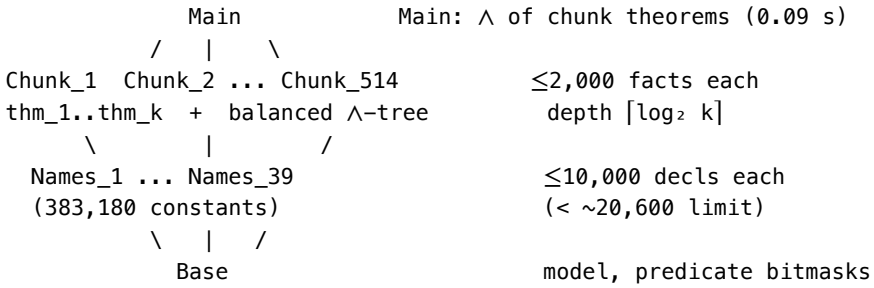
Lean versions differ between the two columns. On the 10,000-fact slice, however, the shallow method costs about the same on both versions (39.6 s CPU on 4.13, 36.1 s on 4.35). This suggested that most of the gap comes from the method, not the Lean version; §6.3.1 tests that directly on one Lean version and finds a smaller gap than this table shows. The version did matter for quantifier-heavy shallow proofs: PLA025+1 took 14–47 s on 4.13 and 4.4 s on 4.35.

10,000-fact slice, Lean 4.35:

Variant	Wall	CPU
Shallow	15.1 s	36.1 s
Reflected, one file	7.1 s	5.1 s
Bare reflection prototype	3.1 s	not recorded

5.4 Illustrations

Hierarchical aggregation (shallow path). Each formula is elaborated exactly once, in its chunk. Main only combines $O(n/2000)$ chunk theorems.



Reflected path: `Base` (model + `Checker.lean`) → `Part_1` … `Part_251` (32 blocks each) → `Main`.

Blocking (reflected encoding).

```
unblocked:   facts ⟶ one Nat of 557,591 bits
             lookup(i) = (N >>> (i·w)) &&& mask      shift touches all N bits
             ⇒ O(N) per lookup, O(N²) per pass       (quadratic)

blocked:     facts ⟶ [B_0][B_1][B_2] ... [B_m]       128 facts per block
             one packed Nat literal per block, fixed-width records
             lookup(i) = decode(B_{i/128}, i mod 128)
             ⇒ O(block) per lookup; whole pass linear in N
```

```
constants: binary search over sorted blocks, O(log m)
```

Block size is a trade-off between per-block overhead and per-lookup shift cost: 128 → 5.11 s, 512 → 5.66 s, 2048 → 7.68 s CPU.

5.5 Negative results

- **Cost-based query planner.** Ordering literals by model table density cut atom checks by 24% on PLA025 but raised them by 14% on NLP219. A planner that wins on one problem and loses on another adds complexity without a reliable gain. The greedy fewest-new-variables order was kept.
- **Hash-consed fact lemmas.** Grouping 9,957 facts into 27 shared lemmas by equivalence class made the build 3× slower (38.8 s vs 12.3 s). Unifying each fact with a shared lemma costs more than deciding the fact directly. This is the clearest confirmation of the central lesson: fewer terms do not help when each one needs more elaboration.
- **Opaque `def` vs `abbrev`** for named propositions had no measurable effect.
- **`rfl` instead of `decide`** for positive facts gave 1.3× (6.75 → 5.12 s). This is a small gain next to the order-of-magnitude effects above.
- **Short-name interning** was not measured.
- **Reflection on quantifier-heavy problems.** PLA025+1 (10-element model) did not finish in 400 s reflected, against 4.4 s shallow on Lean 4.35. The primitive recursor brought it to 228 s, still 50× slower. Hypothesis: lazy kernel evaluation re-decodes subformulas inside quantifier loops. Policy: hybrid dispatch, which reflects when ≥90% of formulas are ground facts and uses the shallow method otherwise.

5.6 Lessons for builders of large Lean certificates

- **Profile before optimizing, and expect elaboration to dominate.** Parsing alone was 41% of a chunk. `decide` itself was a minority of the cost.
- **Never state a formula twice.** Prove each one once, locally, and aggregate proofs hierarchically. Restating 10,000 formulas in Main cost 77 s; aggregating chunk conjunctions cost 0.09 s.
- **Keep every term shallow and every file small.** Use balanced trees for big conjunctions ($\log_2 n$ depth) and keep modules at ≤10,000 declarations. Lean 4.13 had an undocumented failure band near 20,600.
- **Reduce the search before you reduce the proof.** Miniscoping, lazy connectives, greedy join order and flattening turn 10^{11} cases into tens of thousands.
- **For ground data, use reflection, and design the encoding for the kernel.** Use packed blocks (~128 records), $O(1)$ lookups instead of `match` chains, fuel bounded by depth, and `decide +kernel`. For quantifier-heavy problems, stay shallow and dispatch per problem.
- **Distrust sharing that adds unification.** Hash-consed lemmas made the build 3× slower. Fewer terms help only if each one costs the same to elaborate.
- **Engineer the pipeline as carefully as the proof.**
  - Content-addressed caching. Never cache timeouts, because they depend on load.
  - Pick problems from an index instead of sampling.
  - Size worker pools by memory, not cores.
  - Schedule longest jobs first.
  - Fall back to `native_decide` only on a timeout.

6. Evaluation and Case Studies

All measurements were taken on one 8 GB, 8-core laptop. Wall-clock times vary by about 2× with system load. Atom counts and verdicts are exact. Lean versions are stated per result.

6.1 Case study A: a published Lean formalization (Spinoza's *Ethics*)

Question. Nakamura [22] formalizes *Ethics* I in Lean 4 and proves two non-derivability results with hand-built counter-models:

- **S-A12:** A12 does not follow from `StatedAxioms` together with `PSRSubstance`;
- **S-A15:** A15 does not follow from `StatedAxioms` together with plenitude.

Can the tool find these counter-models by itself?

Method.

1. **Read** his `Definitions.lean` and `Axioms.lean` at commit 6d4c046.
2. **Transcribe** them into TPTP: primitives become predicates, `def`s become biconditionals, the 8 nontrivial fields of his `StatedAxioms` register become axioms (the register has 12 fields; 4 are `True` placeholders for A3–A6, and the 8 combine stated-axiom content with an exclusivity rider and his bridge axioms A8–A11, so they are not Spinoza's seven axioms one-for-one), the weaker principle is an axiom and the target is the conjecture.
3. **Validate:** the transcription must reproduce his *positive* results first. Weak P5 follows from `StatedAxioms` + `PSR-Substance`, and A15 from `StatedAxioms` + A25 + A26.
4. **Search blind:** run Vampire on his axioms only, without consulting his `A12CounterModel`.
5. **Certify twice:** once on the transcription, and once as instances of his own `EthicaWorld` and `StatedAxioms` classes, checked against his unmodified library (`nakamura/`, pinned to Lean 4.13).

Results.

Claim	His model (hand-built)	Ours (automatic)	Checked against his library
S-A12	4 elements (`A12CounterModel`)	**2 elements**, 0.1 s	yes; axioms `[propext]`
S-A15	3 elements (`A15CounterModel`)	**2 elements**, 0.1 s	yes; axioms `[propext]`

The models.

- **S-A12:** two substances that *share* one attribute and *differ* in another. The sufficient-reason principle holds, and A12 fails. This is the shape of the classic objection to *Ethics* I P5.
- **S-A15:** two gods, one lacking an attribute of the other.

Caveats. In our models one object can be both a substance and an attribute. That is not an artifact of the encoding: in Nakamura's reconstruction, A10 makes an attribute conceived through itself and A8 identifies that with being in itself, so any attribute *is* a substance. A sorted encoding that kept the two apart would therefore *conflict* with A8 and A10, not just refine them; it would need a revised signature or revised bridges. Also, his definition of God requires at least one attribute, not infinitely many (his source records the stronger cardinality content as a gap). Our smaller models are an automation result within this reconstruction, not evidence of a more faithful reading of Spinoza.

6.1.1 The assumption-dependency map `ablate.py` asks, for each target proposition, whether it follows from the full register, and then, for each axiom, whether it still follows without it. "Needed" means that removing the axiom yields a finite counter-model, **certified by Lean's kernel**. "Not needed" means Vampire still proves the target; that rests on a Vampire proof, which is not certified here. The definitions of substance, attribute and God are held fixed throughout. The run covers 36 experiments, takes 105 s, and is recorded in `ablation/`.

Without ↓ / target →	weak P5	A12	A15
(nothing removed)	follows	**does not follow** (2-element model)	follows
any of the 8 stated axioms	not needed	still does not follow	not needed
A22 (sufficient reason for substances)	**needed** (2-element model)	still does not follow	not needed
A25 (plenitude)	not needed	still does not follow	**needed** (2-element model)
A26 (God is unique)	not needed	still does not follow	**needed** (2-element model)

Subset-minimal sufficient sets (greedy deletion, each step a Vampire proof; this finds *a* minimal set, not necessarily a smallest or the only one, and a Vampire timeout would leave minimality unresolved): weak P5 needs {A22} alone; A15 needs {A25, A26}. These are more than leave-one-out results, since leave-one-out alone cannot show that all individually unneeded axioms can be dropped *together*. They also have direct support upstream: Nakamura's own Lean proofs derive weak P5 from `PSRSubstance` and A15 from the two fields of `PSRPlenitude`, neither using `StatedAxioms` (`ModalForm.lean` at 6d4c046).

Findings:

1. **None of the eight nontrivial fields of Nakamura's stated-axiom register is needed for these results.** Relative to the fixed definitions, the logical work is done by the added sufficient-reason principles. This is a precise form of the Bennett–Della Rocca question for this reconstruction.
2. **A12 is irreducible even against the whole register.** Nakamura shows A12 does not follow from `StatedAxioms` + A22. A certified 2-element model shows it also fails with plenitude (A25) and God's uniqueness (A26) added.
3. **The "needed" results confirm Nakamura's positive Lean proofs** (weak P5 from A22; A15 from A25 + A26) and show that each premise in them is necessary. A counter-model shows non-derivability, not full independence. Independence would also need the negation to be non-derivable, which we do not test. Both claims rest on the soundness of first-order logic, not on any internal Lean theorem about consistency.

Caveats:

- This is the first-order layer of the register only, not its S5 modal layer.
- "Not needed" rests on uncertified Vampire proofs.
- As in §6.1, the counter-models let one object be both a substance and an attribute, which the register permits.

6.2 Case study B: a uniform sample of TPTP

Question. Does the tool work on problems nobody chose for it? When it fails, is it ever *wrong*?

Method.

1. **Index:** from TPTP's ProblemAndSolutionStatistics, keep the 2,561 fof/cnf problems marked Satisfiable or CounterSatisfiable.
2. **Sample** 100 problems, never hand-picked, but **not a uniform sample overall**. The first 20 came from an earlier picker that chose a random *domain*, then a problem in it, which favors problems from small domains. The last 80 were drawn uniformly from the index. The set was also our **development set**: bugs found on it became fixes and regression tests, and it was rerun after each fix. So results on it measure performance on development-exposed problems. §6.2.1 reports a separate held-out set.
3. **Search:** 30 s of Vampire per problem. Results are cached by content, and timeouts are never cached.
4. **Certify** with hybrid dispatch: reflected when at least 90% of formulas are ground facts, shallow otherwise. Lean gets 60 s per file.

Problems were developed in Fibonacci batches (1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8). Every bug found became a regression example, and after the last fix every problem was rerun with the final compiler.

Results (Lean 4.13, shallow; the baseline):

Outcome	Problems
Certified, strict kernel only	67
Certified with `native_decide` (also trusts Lean's compiler)	3
Lean rejected (limits, not wrong models)	6
Vampire found no model within 30 s	23
`cm.py` error (NLP263, before the quoted-name fixes)	1

Results. The first two columns are development history. The **final** column is the frozen implementation (commit `51481a4`: validated reflected certificates, fail-closed parsing, primed variables), run from a separate git worktree on an idle machine with the same 30 s Vampire limit and cache; it is the result this paper reports.

Outcome	Lean 4.13 (shallow)	Lean 4.35 (hybrid, before review)	**Final, frozen `51481a4`**
Models found by Vampire	77	77	77
Certified, strict kernel only	67	70	**70**
Certified with `native_decide`	3	2	2
Lean rejected	6	5	5
Vampire found no model	23	23	20

Outcome	Lean 4.13 (shallow)	Lean 4.35 (hybrid, before review)	**Final, frozen `51481a4`**
Unsupported input (rejected by the parser)	—	—	3
`cm.py` error	1	0	0
Method	shallow ×100	shallow ×98, reflected ×2	shallow ×95, reflected ×2, none ×3
Median end-to-end per problem	3 s	0.65 s (Vampire answers cached)	

Strict kernel certification: 70 of the 77 models Vampire found (90.9%). Two more were certified with `native_decide`, which enlarges the trusted base: 72 of 77 (93.5%) including those. Over all 100 problems, the full pipeline succeeds strictly on 70 (70%). These answer different questions, so all three are reported.

Development subset	Problems	Models found	Strict kernel	+ native	Rejected	No model
First 20 (domain-first picker)	20	17	17 (100% of models)	0	0	2 (+1 unsupported)
Last 80 (uniform from the index)	80	60	53 (88.3%)	2	5	18 (+2 unsupported)
All 100	100	77	70 (90.9%)	2	5	20 (+3 unsupported)

The uniformly drawn 80 certify 88.3% strictly, against 17 of 17 for the domain-first 20. That is a descriptive breakdown, not evidence that the picker caused the difference; the established problem is the non-uniform design itself.

Three verdicts changed between the versions:

- **NLP263+1:** a `cm.py` error on 4.13, certified on 4.35 through the reflective checker (§6.3);
- **HWV048-2:** a 16-element model that overflowed the stack on 4.13 now certifies in 2.7 s. This is consistent with Lean 4.33 bounding kernel recursion by `maxRecDepth`;
- **NLP018-10:** needed `native_decide` on 4.13 and certifies kernel-only on 4.35.

The failures, each explained. On Lean 4.35, **all 5 rejections are one family:** deeply nested modal-logic encodings (LCL647, LCL659, LCL673, LCL683, LCL685). They fail in Lean's *typeclass instance search* for `Decidable`, within seconds, because the formulas are nested too deeply. None is a wrong model. The reflective checker needs no instance search, so it is the natural route for these (§8). The final run's 5 rejections are the same five problems.

Of the 23 problems that were "no model" before review (20 in the final run; the other 3 are now classified as unsupported input), 11 are rated 1.00 in TPTP: no prover solves them in TPTP's reference evaluations. Three more are very large problems on which Vampire gives up, and the rest time out at 30 s. **Four earlier "no model" results turned out to be our own gap.** Vampire had answered them by deleting unused predicates without printing a model. The flag `–updr off` recovered three of them, and the fourth (NLP263) became case study C.

6.2.1 Held-out evaluation with a frozen implementation To measure generalization rather than development fit, we drew a **new sample of 100 problems uniformly without replacement** from the 2,461 eligible problems not in the development set, with seed 20261015 (`bench/heldout-sample.json` records the seed, the method and the problem list). The sample was drawn before any held-out result was seen. Each problem got 30 s of Vampire, then hybrid dispatch, from the frozen commit `51481a4` in a separate git worktree, with no code changes during the run.

Version history, kept rather than hidden. Three earlier attempts at this run are superseded and not reported. A partial run overlapped with a parser change and was discarded. A run frozen at `1a55aef` crashed on the `include` in `SYN000+2`. A run frozen at `a23fe9c` exposed two harness defects (misclassification of unsupported input as *no model*; a Python integer-printing limit) and a timeout caused by our own concurrent jobs. A run at `62d43d6` exposed the variable-capture defect

in GEG001+1 (§8.2). Its verdicts are otherwise identical to the final run, problem for problem. Superseded logs are kept in bench/superseded-*.jsonl.

Outcome	Held-out (100)	Development (100), same commit
Unsupported input (rejected by the parser)	4	3
Vampire found no model within 30 s	35	20
Models found	**61**	**77**
Certified, strict kernel only	**54**	**70**
Certified with native_decide	2	2
Lean rejected (resource limits)	5	5
Strict, of models found	**88.5%**	**90.9%**
Strict or native, of models found	91.8%	93.5%
Full pipeline, strict, of all sampled problems	**54%**	**70%**
Full pipeline, strict, of supported inputs	54 of 96 (56.3%)	70 of 97 (72.2%)

Reading. Conditional on Vampire finding a model, strict certification generalizes: 88.5% held-out against 90.9% on the development set. The pipeline as a whole does not reach the development figure: Vampire found a model for 61 held-out problems against 77, so full-pipeline success is 54% against 70%. The difference lies in the finder's yield within 30 s, not in certification. *No model* means only that none was found within the limit; it is not a semantic result.

Held-out failures. None is an invalid certificate. Three fail in instance search on deeply nested formulas, the same family as all five development failures: LCL649+1.015, LCL681+1.010, and GEG001+1 (an existential over several hundred variables). Two exceed the 60 s Lean limit (NLP055-1, HWV076+1). The two native-assisted problems are NLP179+1 and SWB022+3. The unsupported inputs are three uses of <~> (KRS182+1, KRS199+1, KRS210+1) and one include (SYN000+2).

6.3 Case study C: one million facts (NLP263+1)

NLP263+1 is a natural-language knowledge base: **1,026,857 ground facts over 30 predicates and 383,180 constants**, 70 MB of TPTP. Vampire's model has a single element: every constant denotes it. Checking each fact is therefore trivial, and the problem is pure scale.

The first measurements (Lean 4.13 shallow against Lean 4.35 reflected, single runs, under varying load) suggested about 5× in wall time. Peer review rightly called that comparison uncontrolled, and the reflected certificate has since gained validity and well-formedness checks. §6.3.1 replaces it; the old figures remain only in §5.3, labelled as history.

6.3.1 Controlled comparison bench/perf.py at commit 62d43d6. Lean 4.35.0; Vampire 5.1.0 answers from the cache; Apple M2, 8 cores, 8 GB, macOS 14.4. Each run is a clean build of the generated certificate with **4 parallel Lean workers for both methods**; the checker library is prebuilt and not timed. Shallow and reflected runs alternate, three repetitions each, on an otherwise idle machine (a macOS update service was active in the background). The reflected timings include the validity and well-formedness checks of §4.4.

NLP263+1 (1,026,857 facts)	Shallow: median (range)	**Reflected: median (range)**	Ratio of medians
Wall time	14.1 min (12.6–17.2)	**5.2 min (5.2–5.8)**	2.7×
CPU time	52.5 min (52.3–55.3)	**20.3 min (20.2–21.0)**	2.6×
Peak memory, largest single process	1.42 GB (1.28–1.48)	**0.50 GB (0.49–0.51)**	2.8×
Peak memory, all concurrent Lean processes	2.67 GB (2.67–2.69)	**1.86 GB (1.85–1.87)**	1.4×
Axioms	none	propext, Quot.sound	

10,000-fact slice of NLP263+1	Shallow: median (range)	**Reflected: median (range)**	Ratio of medians
Wall time	10.9 s (9.8–11.4)	**4.4 s (4.1–4.7)**	2.5×
CPU time	31.1 s (31.0–32.0)	**9.8 s (9.5–10.0)**	3.2×
Peak memory, largest single process	0.90 GB (0.82–0.96)	**0.46 GB (0.46–0.46)**	2.0×
Peak memory, all concurrent Lean processes	2.02 GB (1.94–2.12)	**1.33 GB (1.32–1.34)**	1.5×

What this supports. Under matched conditions, reflection certifies this ground-fact workload about **2.5–3× faster** and with about 3× less memory per process, but only about 1.4× less memory in aggregate. That is roughly half the speedup the uncontrolled comparison suggested. CPU time varies by under 6% across repetitions; shallow wall time varies by 37% (12.6–17.2 min), most likely from memory pressure on an 8 GB machine, since CPU time stays flat. Both problems have one-element models, so these are **throughput stress tests**, not evidence about larger domains or quantifier depth, where reflection is slower (§4.5, §8).

Definitions (also stored in each record of `bench/perf.jsonl`). Wall time runs from invoking `cm.py` to the end of the final `#print axioms` check; model search is excluded (cached). CPU time is user plus system time over all child processes. Peak memory is reported two ways: the largest single process's maximum resident set size (`/usr/bin/time -l`), and the largest sum of resident set sizes of concurrently running Lean processes, sampled every 0.2 s. A fresh kernel replay (`leanchecker --fresh`) is timed separately (§3.10), not included.

How this problem forced the scaling recipe. It crashed `cm.py`, because of `%` inside a quoted gloss. It then crashed Lean's kernel twice, on a 10,000-long conjunction and on a file with more than about 20,600 declarations. And it exposed a variable-capture hazard, through a constant named `'T'`. Each failure became one of the patterns in §5.

6.4 Summary

	Evidence
Generality	Strict certification of 70 of 77 models (development) and 54 of 61 (held-out, frozen code); no failure is a wrong model
Scale	1,026,857 facts certified in a median 5.2 min reflected, against 14.1 min shallow, under matched conditions (§6.3.1)
Usefulness on real formal work	Automatic, smaller counter-models for a published Lean formalization
Trust	Strict certificates use kernel checks and standard axioms only (2 more native-assisted, reported separately); reflected certificates prove ordinary first-order satisfaction (§4.4); four real bugs in trusted layers caught by independent checks, and two more found during the review: silent misreading of unsupported syntax, and variable capture, which failed closed

7. Related Work

This work sits where four lines of research meet: counter-model finders attached to proof assistants, automated provers connected to Lean, proof by reflection with verified checkers, and very large machine-generated Lean certificates. Each is mature on its own. Below we say what each line does, where it differs from `lean-countermodel`, and what we could and could not verify. Every claim about another work was checked against the source listed in References on 2026-10-15. Where a source did not settle a point, we say so.

7.1 Counter-model finding in proof assistants

Isabelle: Nitpick and Nunchaku. Nitpick [3] is a counterexample generator for Isabelle/HOL. It translates higher-order goals into relational logic and solves them with Kodkod [4], a SAT-based relational model finder. Nitpick covers far more than we do: higher-order logic, (co)inductive datatypes and (co)recursive functions. It does not produce a certificate for Isabelle's kernel, however. A model it reports as genuine is trusted on the strength of the translation and of Kodkod. Nunchaku was announced as a successor to Nitpick that several proof assistants could use [5, 6]. Its repository still describes it as "in initial development phase, not ready for use" [6], and we found no Lean front end for it.

HOL4: HolRefute. HolRefute [2] is an open pull request against HOL4, opened on 2026-09-04 and **not merged** when we checked on 2026-10-15. It adds Quickcheck, narrowing and a Kodkod model finder that it describes as a "module-for-module port of Nitpick (Isabelle2025-2)". It also replays counterexamples: "every counterexample is replayed and, where replay succeeds, turned into a HOL theorem". Replay fails closed. Its trust policy still accepts a `Genuine` verdict that has no certificate, as Nitpick does with Kodkod, and the commit history shows this policy was argued over before being kept [2]. So HolRefute is the closest analogue in another system: an untrusted finder whose output is, where possible, re-proved by the kernel. It differs from our work in three ways. It targets HOL4. It replays by kernel evaluation (`computeLib`, `EVAL`) and by decision procedures rather than through a verified first-order evaluator. And certification is best-effort, whereas we report a model only when Lean has certified it.

Equational Theories Project (ETP). The ETP [1] settled all 22,028,942 implications between 4,694 equational laws of magmas and formalized the results in Lean. Its finite-magma counterexamples came from brute force, SAT solvers (Glucose, Kissat), Mace4 [7] and Vampire [24], among other methods [1, §5]. A custom `Facts` command packs one finite magma that refutes many implications into a single theorem. The theorems are proved with a decision tactic (`decideFin!` in the paper's Figure 6), and "tactics such as native_decide that relied on external tools were not permitted into the codebase" [1, §3]. The formalized generating set has 10,657 positive and 586,925 negative implications, most of the negative ones held in `Facts` theorems [1, §3]. The ETP is the largest precedent we know of for kernel-checked finite counter-models in Lean. Its machinery is specific to one signature: one binary operation, with equations indexed by number. It is not a general first-order tool. The project also reconstructed Vampire *proofs* in Lean [1, §7, Fig. 10].

Lean: Lean Disprove and `plausible`. Lean Disprove (Jan Ondras and Cameron Freer, 3rd AI for Math Workshop at ICML 2026) [10] is a `/disprove` command for coding agents in the `lean4-skills` package [11]. It runs a bounded six-phase search with a registry of methods: "decision procedures, finite enumeration, random sampling, and external scripts such as SAT/SMT queries". It reports `REFUTED` only "when Lean accepts the refutation" [10]. We share its rule that external witnesses are never trusted. As described, its search works over the types a Lean goal already mentions. Its method registry does not include a first-order model finder that invents a new carrier and interpretations for uninterpreted symbols. `plausible` [12] is property-based testing for Lean 4. It samples and shrinks counterexamples over types with `SampleableExt` or `Arbitrary` instances. It reports counterexamples and does not produce a proof of the negation [12].

Model finders. Mace4 [7] searches for finite models of first-order formulas by grounding and equational rewriting. Its manual describes it as complementary to theorem provers, as a searcher for countermodels. Vampire's finite-model builder [24], which we use, plays the same role. Neither finder's output is checked by a proof assistant unless a tool like ours does it.

Finite models turned into proof-assistant certificates in Coq. The closest predecessor of this work's core idea is Goubault-Larrecq's *Finite Models for Formal Security Proofs* [32]. It extracts finite models of first-order clause sets that represent security protocols, model-checks them, and instruments the checker to output a formally checkable proof, for example in Coq. It differs from this work in input (protocol clause sets), prover integration and target system, and it does not use reflection in Lean or work at the scale reported here. But the finite-model-to-certificate idea precedes us. Separately, Kirst and Larchey-Wendling mechanize first-order finite model theory constructively in Coq [33]: semantic background rather than an external-certificate tool, but it further limits any novelty claim about the checker concept itself.

7.2 Prover integration in Lean

Lean can already import proofs. Duper [18] is a proof-producing superposition prover written in Lean. Lean-auto [16] translates Lean goals for external automated provers. LeanHammer [17] combines a neural premise selector with these components into what its authors call "the first end-to-end domain general hammer for the Lean proof assistant". "Lean on Vampire Proofs" (Bodingbauer, Hajdu, Kovács, Polaczek and Rawson) [8] reconstructs Vampire proofs as trusted Lean proofs. A companion library, `vprover/vamplean` [9], is "required by Lean for checking generated proof files". Its

repository does not link the paper, so we infer the connection from the shared authorship and purpose. We could not confirm from arXiv that the paper appears at ITP 2026; the arXiv record lists it as a short paper only [8].

All of this work moves **proofs** from a prover into Lean, so it certifies *validity*. We move **models**, which certify *non-validity* or consistency. The two directions complement each other. Run on the same TPTP problem, Vampire either finds a refutation, which [8] can replay, or a finite model, which we can certify. To our knowledge, none of [8, 9, 16, 17, 18] imports models.

7.3 Certificates by reflection

Proof by reflection has a standard shape. Write a checker as a Lean function, prove it sound once, and let evaluation carry each instance. Recent Lean work applies this shape to *proof* certificates.

- **PBLean** [13] checks VeriPB pseudo-Boolean proofs with a Boolean checker whose soundness is "fully proved in Lean and executed as compiled native code", that is through `native_decide`. This puts Lean's compiler, and the axiom `Lean.ofReduceBool`, in the trusted base.
- **Streaming LRAT** [14] turns a SAT solver's LRAT certificate into a Lean theorem. It streams the certificate through Lean core's verified LRAT checker, made resumable, and reports importing 174 TB of certificates in a scaling experiment. The abstract does not say whether the final check is kernel-only or compiled. We did not establish which.
- **`bv_decide`** (Lean 4.12) [15] reduces `BitVec`/`Bool` goals to SAT. CaDiCaL refutes the instance, and "the resulting LRAT proof is checked in Lean". The release notes state that its proofs "use `Lean.ofReduceBool`", so the compiler is trusted.

Our reflected checker (`Checker.lean`, §4) follows the same pattern for a different object. It verifies that a **finite structure satisfies a first-order formula**, under Tarski semantics, rather than that a derivation is correct. It also makes a different trust choice: certificates are checked with `decide +kernel` and use only `propext` and `Quot.sound`. Neither `native_decide` nor `Lean.ofReduceBool` is used. That rule matches the ETP's ban on `native_decide` [1]. Measured costs of the choice are in §5–§6.

7.4 Large finite certificates in Lean

Two papers by Florath show the proof-carrying-data pattern in Lean 4 for covering codes. In [19], a database stores bounds together with traces that "replay to Lean proofs". In [20], $K_8(4, 2) = 23$ is proved from an explicit 23-word code and two LRAT refutations, with "no external SAT solver used during proof replay". The ETP [1] remains the largest example of finite counter-models in Lean: about 587,000 negative implications, packed into `Facts` theorems because "explicitly formalizing all 22 028 942 implications as theorems would lead to an infeasible compilation time in Lean" [1, §3]. That observation agrees with our central measurement in §5: for large generated Lean files, elaboration dominates the cost. None of [1, 19, 20] gives a per-phase profile or a declarations-per-file limit, which is what we contribute there.

Two further items bear on scaling. Lean 4.33 [27] "bounds kernel type checking by `maxRecDepth` rather than the physical stack", making "`(kernel) deep recursion detected` deterministic across platforms and builds". This is why our Lean 4.13 limits may not carry over to later Lean versions (§8). Our search reductions reuse classic first-order preprocessing, in particular miniscoping, which pushes quantifiers inward as in standard clause-normal-form computation [26]. We claim no novelty for these patterns, only for measuring them on Lean certificates.

7.5 Formalized philosophy

Nakamura [22] formalizes Part I of Spinoza's *Ethics* in Lean 4 and gives two counter-models. The abstract names "a four-element counter-model" for Proposition V and a second one for axiom A15. The abstract also notes that the non-derivability claim is "itself a meta-logical consequence of kernel consistency". Our §6.1 reproduces both counter-models from the axioms alone, with 2 elements in each case, and certifies them against Nakamura's unmodified library.

Benzmüller [21] ports the Isabelle/HOL dataset on Gödel's and Scott's ontological arguments to Lean 4 and to TPTP THF/SMT-LIB. The result is 294 theorems plus 45 statements that the original refutes or leaves open. None of the provers evaluated proves any of the 45. The ancillary files include `tools/thf/run_nitpick.py`, so Nitpick appears to be used on the THF side, but the material we read does not say how it is used. Those problems are higher-order (THF), which is outside our untyped `fof`/`cnf` scope. Their first-order fragments are a natural target for future work.

7.6 Comparison

	Logic / inputs	Finds models?	Kernel-certified?	General FOL?	Reusable tool?	Reflection?
Nitpick [3]	Isabelle/HOL goals (higher-order)	Yes (Kodkod)	No: Kodkod trusted	Yes, and more (HOL)	Yes	No
HolRefute [2]	HOL4 goals (higher-order)	Yes (Kodkod port of Nitpick; also Quickcheck, narrowing)	Partly: replayed to a HOL theorem when replay succeeds; uncertified `Genuine` verdicts allowed	Yes, and more (HOL)	Yes, but unmerged PR as of 2026-10-15	No: replay by evaluation and decision procedures
ETP [1]	Equational laws on magmas	Yes (brute force, SAT, Mace4, Vampire, other methods)	Yes: `decide`-style tactic, `native_decide` banned	No: one signature	No: project-specific	Not described
Goubault-Larrecq [32]	First-order clause sets (security protocols)	Yes (finite-model extraction)	Yes: Coq-checkable proofs	Clause sets of that domain	Research system	No (instrumented checker)
Lean Disprove [10]	Lean goals	Yes, within the goal's types (enumeration, sampling, SAT/SMT)	Yes: `REFUTED` only when Lean accepts	No first-order model finder as described	Yes (`lean4-skills`)	Not described
`plausible` [12]	Lean props over sampleable types	Yes (random testing)	No: no proof produced	No	Yes	No
Lean on Vampire Proofs [8, 9]	Vampire proofs (FOL, HOL, theories)	No (proofs)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Not stated in abstract
PBLean / LRAT [13, 14]	PB / CNF proof certificates	No (unsatisfiability proofs)	PBLean: compiled (`native_decide`); LRAT: Lean core's verified checker, mode not verified by us	No (propositional / PB)	Yes	Yes (verified checker)

	Logic / inputs	Finds models?	Kernel-certified?	General FOL?	Reusable tool?	Reflection?
This work	TPTP `fof`/`cnf` problems (untyped; §8 lists unsupported features)	Yes (Vampire `-sa fmb`)	Yes, under a strict kernel-only policy (`propext`, `Quot.sound`); reflected certificates prove ordinary satisfaction via `sem_iff_sat`	Yes (untyped FOL)	Yes	Yes (reflected mode); shallow mode also

7.7 What is new here

No single technique here is new. Finite model finding [4, 7, 24], kernel-checked finite counter-models in Lean [1], untrusted finders checked by replay [2, 10], provers connected to Lean [8, 16, 17, 18] and verified reflective checkers [13, 14, 15] all exist. The combination does not appear to: models of **arbitrary untyped first-order problems** found by an external prover, certified by Lean's **kernel alone** through a **verified Tarski-semantics evaluator**, scaling to a million-fact problem.

We found no direct precedent for the exact combination, but our first search missed a close Coq predecessor [32], found in peer review. That is a reminder that a focused search supports "we found no implementation with this combination", never "first ever". The search had limits. On 2026-10-15 we searched the web for combinations of "Lean 4", "finite model finder", "counter-model", "TPTP", "Vampire", "Mace4", "certificate" and "kernel". We searched for Lean ports of Nitpick or Nunchaku, including Lean Zulip discussions, and for verified first-order model checkers in Coq, Isabelle and Lean. We also read the sources above for mentions of model import. The closest results were the works in this section. The searches also surfaced SMTCoq (SMT certificate checking in Coq) and a February 2026 arXiv preprint on rewrite-system certificates for *infinite* counter-models in the unit equational fragment. We did not read either in full, so we do not cite them. We did not search the Lean Zulip archive directly or non-English literature.

8. Limitations and Future Work

8.1 Supported input

`cm.py` reads self-contained, untyped TPTP problems. Since peer review, unsupported features are **rejected with an error**, never translated: an earlier version silently misread several of them (§5).

Feature	Status
`fof`, `cnf` statements	supported
Roles: `axiom`, `hypothesis`, `definition`, `lemma`, `theorem`, `negated_conjecture`; `conjecture` (negated in the certificate)	supported (non-conjecture roles are treated as assumptions)
Connectives `~ & | => <=>`; quantifiers `! ?`; `=`, `!=`; `$true`, `$false`	supported
Plain and quoted names (`cat` and `'cat'` are one symbol; `'X'` is never a variable)	supported, tested
`%` comments, including `%` inside quoted names	supported, tested
Connectives `<~>`, `<=`, `~|`, `~&`	**rejected**
`$distinct`, other `$`-defined symbols, numbers, strings	**rejected**
`tff`, `thf`, `tcf`, `tpi` statements	**rejected** (the whole file)

Feature	Status
`include(...)`	**rejected** by `cm.py`. The benchmark harness, when it downloads a problem, inlines each plain `include('Axioms/F.ax').` by textual substitution of that axiom file (`bench.fetch`; trusted, untested code). A *selective* include, `include('Axioms/F.ax', [names])`, is not inlined, so the input is rejected and recorded as *unsupported input* (`SYN000+2`)
One symbol used at two arities (TPTP's `p/1` and `p/2` are distinct symbols)	**rejected** (the model tables are keyed by name)
Purely propositional problems Vampire settles without printing a finite model	not handled (no model to certify)

8.2 Limitations

Limitation	Effect	Path forward
No front end inside Lean	Users write TPTP by hand	A Lean command that exports the current goal (first-order part) to TPTP and applies the certificate. This is the step that makes the tool adoptable.
Reflected checking of nested quantifiers is slow	PLA025+1 did not finish in 400 s reflected, against 4.4 s shallow, so we dispatch by fact share	Decode once, then check (`decode D = L`, then `check L`), so that lazy kernel evaluation stops re-decoding subformulas inside quantifier loops
Trusted translation and rewriting	A bug here can certify the wrong statement. It happened once (§5) and was caught by an independent check; peer review prompted a second class (silent misreading of unsupported syntax), now closed by fail-closed parsing. An audit of every archived input (`bench/input-audit.json`) found 3 development inputs with unsupported syntax; all 3 were *no model*, so no certificate was affected. The frozen held-out run then exposed variable capture: `GEG001+1` binds a variable named `T`, the domain type's name; Lean rejected the certificate, and variables are now emitted primed (`X'`). Fail-closed parsing also shares its lexer with the test oracle, so correlated lexing errors remain possible.	Prove the rewrites in Lean, or emit both the original and the rewritten formula and prove them equivalent
Untyped first-order logic only	No sorts, arithmetic or higher-order input	TPTP `tff` sorts, using Vampire's multi-sorted models
Vampire's limits are our limits	23 of 100 sampled problems had no model within 30 s; 11 of them are rated 1.00 by TPTP	Longer limits; other finders such as Mace4 or SAT-based search
Some formats are unread	Purely propositional problems that Vampire settles without printing a finite model	Parse Vampire's other model formats

Limitation	Effect	Path forward
Lean-version effects	Lean 4.13's limit of about 20,600 declarations per file may not hold on Lean $\geq$ 4.33, which changed how kernel recursion is bounded	Re-test on current Lean before reporting upstream
Spinoza encoding	Our 2-element models let objects be both substances and attributes, as Nakamura's axioms allow	A sorted encoding
Sample, not census	A 100-problem development set (the first 20 picked by domain) and a 100-problem held-out set (§6.2.1)	The full 2,561, now cheap with caching and indexing
Hybrid dispatch threshold	The 90% fact-share threshold was chosen during development, and only a few problems use reflection	Validate it on problems with intermediate fact shares
Non-derivability, not independence	A counter-model shows a target does not follow; independence also needs its negation not to follow	Run both directions in `ablate.py`

9. Conclusion

Counter-models are how one shows that something does *not* follow. With `lean-countermodel`, Lean 4 users can get them for any first-order theory: Vampire finds them, Lean's kernel certifies them, and Vampire is never trusted.

The tool is small. The work was in making certificates finish. One lesson recurred on the ground-fact workloads we measured: **Lean's cost lay in elaborating statements, not in evaluating them.** Each pattern that reduced elaboration paid off, among them balanced trees, hierarchical aggregation, compact encodings and reflection through a once-verified evaluator. The patterns that added elaboration or unification work backfired, and we report those too.

The verified checker turns a certificate into a single statement: the ordinary first-order structure the model describes satisfies every formula of the problem. It depends only on Lean's standard axioms, and every shipped certificate replays through `leanchecker --fresh`. With it, a million-fact problem is certified in a median of 5.2 minutes on a laptop, about 2.7× faster than one theorem per formula under matched conditions. The tool also reproduces, automatically and with smaller models, the hand-built counter-models of a published Lean formalization.

The remaining gap is the user's side: a command inside Lean that takes a goal and returns a certified counter-model. The checker and the scaling recipe are the foundation for it.

Appendix A: Reproducing Every Number

Result	Command	Data
Unit and integration tests	`pytest test_cm.py`	102 tests
Axioms and fresh kernel replay of all shipped certificates	`./recheck.sh`	writes `bench/recheck.log`
Examples (shallow)	`lake build; lake env lean Axioms.lean`	`examples/`, `Cm/`
One reflected certificate	`python3 cm.py --reflect examples/group_comm.p > G.lean && lake env lean G.lean`	—
Nakamura, against his library	`cd nakamura && lake build && lake env lean Axioms.lean`	spinoza-ethica-lean @ 6d4c046
TPTP development sample (original sampling)	`python3 bench.py N [WORKERS]`	`bench/eligible.tsv`, `bench/results*.jsonl`

Result	Command	Data
Frozen development and held-out runs (§6.2, §6.2.1)	`python3 bench/frozen.py <repo>/bench`, from a worktree of `51481a4` (usage in the file)	`bench/heldout-sample.json`, `bench/results-final-*.jsonl`, `bench/superseded-*.jsonl`
Input audit (§8)	see `method` in the file	`bench/input-audit.json`
Controlled timings (§6.3.1)	`python3 bench/perf.py bench/problems/NLP263+1.p 3 4`; `python3 bench/perf.py bench/slice10000.p 3 4` (the first 10,000 statements of NLP263+1)	`bench/perf.jsonl`
NLP263	`python3 cm.py --reflect bench/problems/NLP263+1.p DIR`, then build the modules	`bench/nlp263-*.json`

Requirements: Lean 4.35 via elan (`nakamura/` uses 4.13), Vampire 5.1, and Python 3.12.

References

All sources were accessed on 2026-10-15. Marks used below:

- **[verified]:** we read the source itself (abstract page, paper text, repository or release notes), or its publisher metadata through Crossref.
- **[partly verified]:** one part of the entry could not be confirmed. The entry says which part.

1. M. Bolan, J. Breitner, J. Brox, N. Carlini, M. Carneiro, F. van Doorn, M. Dvorak, A. Goens, A. Hill, H. Husum, H. Ibarra Mejia, Z. A. Kocsis, B. Le Floch, A. Livne Bar-on, L. Luccioli, D. McNeil, A. Meiburg, P. Monticone, P. P. Nielsen, E. O. Osazuwa, G. Paolini, M. Petracci, B. Reinke, D. Renshaw, M. Rossel, C. Roux, J. Scanvic, S. Srinivas, A. R. Tadipatri, T. Tao, V. Tsyrklevich, F. Vaquerizo-Villar, D. Weber, F. Zheng. *The Equational Theories Project: Advancing Collaborative Mathematical Research at Scale.* arXiv:2512.07087, 2025. https://arxiv.org/abs/2512.07087 · PDF: https://teorth.github.io/equational_theories/paper.pdf **[verified]**: §3, §5 and §7 were read in the PDF text.
2. HOL-Theorem-Prover/HOL pull request #2051 (author `lukaszcz`). *HolRefute: Quickcheck, narrowing and a Nitpick-style Kodkod model finder.* Opened 2026-09-04; **open and unmerged** as of 2026-10-15. https://github.com/HOL-Theorem-Prover/HOL/pull/2051 **[verified]**: we read the PR description and the first part of the page. The remaining 60k characters, mostly commit history, were not read.
3. J. C. Blanchette, T. Nipkow. *Nitpick: A Counterexample Generator for Higher-Order Logic Based on a Relational Model Finder.* Interactive Theorem Proving (ITP 2010), LNCS, pp. 131–146, Springer, 2010. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-642-14052-5_11 **[verified]** (Crossref metadata; the description is from the authors' page at https://www21.in.tum.de/~nipkow/pubs/itp10.pdf)
4. E. Torlak, D. Jackson. *Kodkod: A Relational Model Finder.* Tools and Algorithms for the Construction and Analysis of Systems (TACAS 2007), LNCS, pp. 632–647, Springer, 2007. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-540-71209-1_49 **[partly verified]**: title, authors, venue and pages come from Crossref. The Crossref record has no year; 2007 is inferred from the TACAS 2007 volume.
5. A. Reynolds, J. C. Blanchette, S. Cruanes, C. Tinelli. *Model Finding for Recursive Functions in SMT.* IJCAR 2016. https://homepage.divms.uiowa.edu/~tinelli/papers/ReyEtAl-IJCAR-16.pdf **[partly verified]**: authors, title, and the fact that the method is implemented in CVC4 and the "higher-order model finder" Nunchaku were confirmed from a search result describing this PDF. We did not open the PDF itself.
6. Nunchaku (repository). https://github.com/nunchaku-inria/nunchaku **[verified]**: the README states "currently in initial development phase, not ready for use". No last-commit date was visible.
7. W. McCune. *Mace4 Reference Manual and Guide.* Argonne National Laboratory Technical Memorandum ANL/MCS-TM-264, 2003. arXiv:cs/0310055. https://arxiv.org/abs/cs/0310055 **[verified]**
8. J. Bodingbauer, M. Hajdu, L. Kovács, A. Polaczek, M. Rawson. *Lean on Vampire Proofs (Short Paper).* 17th International Conference on Interactive Theorem Proving (ITP 2026), LIPIcs 382, 36:1–36:9, 2026. https://doi.org/10.4230/LIPIcs.ITP.2026.36 (also arXiv:2603.26342) **[verified]** (the publisher record lists `vprover/vamplean` and Vampire's `leancheck` branch as supplementary software)

9. `vprover/vamplean`: "Library required by Lean for checking generated proof files". https://github.com/vprover/vamplean **[verified]**: we confirmed the repository and its description. Its link to [8] is inferred: the repository does not cite the paper.
10. J. Ondras, C. Freer. *Lean Disprove: Certified Counterexample Search for AI-Assisted Formal Mathematics.* 3rd AI for Math Workshop: Toward Self-Evolving Scientific Agents, ICML 2026. https://icml.cc/virtual/2026/82610 · OpenReview: https://openreview.net/forum?id=5ck1jRE65S **[verified]**: we read the ICML listing. The first author's full name is Jan Ondras. We did not open the OpenReview page.
11. C. Freer et al. `lean4-skills` (repository; includes the `disprove` workflow). https://github.com/cameronfreer/lean4-skills **[verified]**
12. `plausible`: a property-based testing framework for Lean 4. https://github.com/leanprover-community/plausible **[verified]**
13. S. Szeider. *PBLean: Pseudo-Boolean Proof Certificates for Lean 4.* arXiv:2602.08692, 2026. https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.08692 **[verified]**: we read the abstract. The use of `native_decide` was confirmed from a search summary of the paper's HTML version.
14. S. Szeider. *Streaming LRAT Certificates into Lean Theorems.* arXiv:2607.00815, 2026. https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.00815 **[verified]**: abstract only. Whether the final check runs in the kernel or as compiled code is not settled by the abstract.
15. Lean 4.12.0 release notes (`bv_decide`). https://lean-lang.org/doc/reference/latest/releases/v4.12.0/ **[verified]**
16. Y. Qian, J. Clune, C. Barrett, J. Avigad. *Lean-Auto: An Interface Between Lean 4 and Automated Theorem Provers.* Computer Aided Verification (CAV 2025), LNCS, pp. 175–196, Springer, 2025. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-98682-6_10 **[verified]** (Crossref metadata only)
17. T. Zhu, J. Clune, J. Avigad, A. Q. Jiang, S. Welleck. *Premise Selection for a Lean Hammer.* arXiv:2506.07477, 2025. https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.07477 **[verified]**
18. J. Clune, Y. Qian, A. Bentkamp, J. Avigad. *Duper: A Proof-Producing Superposition Theorem Prover for Dependent Type Theory.* ITP 2024, LIPIcs 309, 10:1–10:20, 2024. https://doi.org/10.4230/LIPIcs.ITP.2024.10 **[verified]**
19. A. Florath. *Formal Foundations and Proof-Carrying Certificates for q-ary Covering Codes in Lean 4.* arXiv:2606.09600, 2026. https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.09600 **[verified]** (abstract)
20. A. Florath. *A Lean-Certified Proof of $K_8(4, 2) = 23$.* arXiv:2606.16688, 2026. https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.16688 **[verified]** (abstract)
21. C. Benzmüller. *Gödel's and Scott's Variants of the Ontological Argument in Lean 4 and TPTP THF.* arXiv:2609.26806, 2026 (v3, 2026-10-01). https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.26806 **[verified]**: we read the abstract and the ancillary file list. How the Nitpick script `tools/thf/run_nitpick.py` is used is **unverified**.
22. Y. Nakamura. *Bennett's Conjecture in Lean 4: Counter-Models for the PSR-Reducibility of Spinoza's Propositions V and XIV.* arXiv:2605.02331, 2026. https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.02331 · Code: https://github.com/Nakammura/spinoza-ethica-lean **[verified]**: we read the abstract. The 4- and 3-element model sizes come from our own reading of the Lean source (§6.1).
23. G. Sutcliffe. *The TPTP Problem Library and Associated Infrastructure: From CNF to TH0, TPTP v6.4.0.* Journal of Automated Reasoning 59(4), pp. 483–502, 2017. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10817-017-9407-7 **[partly verified]**: Crossref confirms the title "The TPTP Problem Library and Associated Infrastructure", the author, volume 59, pp. 483–502, and 2017. The subtitle and the issue number (4) were not in the Crossref record.
24. L. Kovács, A. Voronkov. *First-Order Theorem Proving and Vampire.* Computer Aided Verification (CAV 2013), LNCS, pp. 1–35, Springer, 2013. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-642-39799-8_1 **[verified]** (Crossref metadata)
25. L. de Moura, S. Ullrich. *The Lean 4 Theorem Prover and Programming Language.* Automated Deduction – CADE 28, LNCS, pp. 625–635, Springer, 2021. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-79876-5_37 **[verified]** (Crossref metadata)
26. A. Nonnengart, C. Weidenbach. *Computing Small Clause Normal Forms.* In A. Robinson, A. Voronkov (eds.), Handbook of Automated Reasoning, pp. 335–367, Elsevier, 2001. https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-044450813-3/50008-4 **[partly verified]**: Crossref confirms the title, authors, book, pages and year. The editors and the statement that the chapter covers miniscoping are from general knowledge; we did not open the chapter.
27. Lean 4.33.0 release notes (#13956: kernel type checking bounded by `maxRecDepth`). https://lean-lang.org/doc/reference/latest/re **[verified]**
28. P. Grim, D. Singer. *Computational Philosophy.* Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy, first published 2020, substantive revision 13 May 2024. https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/computational-philosophy/ **[verified]**
29. B. Fitelson, E. N. Zalta. *Steps Toward a Computational Metaphysics.* Journal of Philosophical Logic 36(2): 227–247, 2007. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10992-006-9038-7 **[verified via [28]'s bibliography]**
30. P. E. Oppenheimer, E. N. Zalta. *A Computationally-Discovered Simplification of the Ontological Argument.* Australasian Journal of Philosophy 89(2): 333–349, 2011. https://doi.org/10.1080/00048401003674482 **[verified via**

[28]'s bibliography]

31. J. K. Horner. *A Computationally Assisted Reconstruction of an Ontological Argument in Spinoza's The Ethics.* Open Philosophy 2(1): 211–229, 2019. https://doi.org/10.1515/opphil-2019-0012 **[verified via [28]'s bibliography]**
32. J. Goubault-Larrecq. *Finite Models for Formal Security Proofs.* Journal of Computer Security 18(6): 1247–1299, 2010. https://doi.org/10.3233/JCS-2009-0395 **[verified]**: extracts finite models of first-order clause sets for security protocols, model-checks them, and can output a formally checkable proof, e.g. in Coq.
33. D. Kirst, D. Larchey-Wendling. *Trakhtenbrot's Theorem in Coq: A Constructive Approach to Finite Model Theory.* IJCAR 2020. Extended version: arXiv:2104.14445. https://www.ps.uni-saarland.de/extras/fol-trakh/ **[verified]**
34. G. Sutcliffe. *The SZS Ontologies: Success.* https://szs.tptp.org/success **[verified]**: *Satisfiable* and *CounterSatisfiable* do not imply a finite model; *FinitelySatisfiable* and *FinitelyCounterSatisfiable* are separate statuses.
35. Lean 4.35 Language Reference: *Validating a Lean Proof.* https://lean-lang.org/doc/reference/4.35.0/ValidatingProofs/ **[verified]**: since Lean 4.29, native evaluation adds one dedicated axiom per computation (names containing `_native`); the `Lean.trustCompiler` machinery was removed in 4.35.